

Teacher Guide — French Revolution

History | Grade 9-10

Period 1

ENTRY TICKET

On the paper in front of you, write two things: (1) one short line that gives the start date of the French Revolution and the event that marks that start; (2) one short line that gives the commonly given end date and the event that marks that end. Then, put a star next to the end event if you think the Revolution ended with a change in government power (a coup, a leader removed) and a question mark if you think it ended because the ideas or society had already changed. You have 4 minutes.

Expected response: Start: 1789 — Estates General (commonly given start). End: 9 November 1799 — Coup of 18 Brumaire (commonly given end). Star (because it ended with a change in government power). Note: some students may write 1793 (execution of Robespierre) or 1815 (Napoleon's defeat) — those are common alternative views.

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Collect answers & display variety

Quickly collect a few student papers (or ask 3 volunteers to read their two lines aloud). Hold up one that gives 1789–1799 and one that gives an alternative end date (for example 1793 or 1815). Say: “Thank you. I’m holding one that gives 1789–1799 and one that gives 1789–1793. Keep those in mind — we’ll return to why people pick different end dates.” Then write the class into groups of four for the next activity: Group A sit at front-left, B front-right, C back-left, D back-right.

Board: Write the two answers you collected as short lines: “Example 1: 1789 — 9 Nov 1799 (Coup of 18 Brumaire)” and “Example 2: 1789 — 1793 (common alternative)”. Label groups A–D.

- Anticipate: Why are we collecting different answers? — Because historians disagree; we will learn the commonly given dates and why other dates are chosen.
- Anticipate: Do we have to memorize those dates? — Yes: you should be able to recall the commonly given start and end dates and the source phrasing.
- Anticipate: What if I wrote a different start than 1789? — Ask the student: what did you write and why? (You may have reasons; we will use the class definition.)

5-15 min: Introduce official definition and causes overview

Say: “Now I will give you the definition we will use in this unit. I will read it aloud and then we will underline the key parts.” Read exactly: “The French Revolution was a period of political and societal change in France that began with the Estates General of 1789 and ended with the Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799.” Ask students: “Which words tell us this is about both politics and society?” Pause for answers and underline those words. Next read the causes sentence aloud exactly: “The Revolution resulted from multiple long-term and short-term social, economic, financial and political factors culminating in crisis in the late 1780s; resistance to

reform by the ruling elite and indecisive policy by Louis XVI contributed.” Ask: “Name two kinds of causes mentioned.” Take two quick answers and confirm.

Board: Write the full definition sentence exactly and write the causes sentence exactly below it. Underline: “political and societal change” and “Estates General of 1789” and “Coups of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799”. Underline in the causes sentence: “long-term and short-term”, and list the four factor words after it: social, economic, financial, political.

- Anticipate: What does 'societal change' mean? — It means changes in how people related to each other and in social rules, not only who ruled.
- Anticipate: Why does the definition use Estates General as the start? — Because historians commonly mark that event as the moment the crisis became political and national.
- Anticipate: Is 9 November 1799 the same as 18 Brumaire? — Yes; 18 Brumaire is the French Revolutionary calendar name for that date.

15-30 min: Guided group discussion / role play on causes

Explain the task: “In your groups of four, assign roles: two students give evidence for a long-term cause (pick social or economic), one gives evidence for a short-term cause (pick financial or political), and one is the recorder who will write one sentence saying which cause they think mattered most and why. You have 10 minutes.” Circulate: for Group A suggest they use the example of unequal social orders (Estates) as a long-term social cause and rising bread prices as an economic cause; for Group B suggest high government debt as a short-term financial cause and the king’s indecisive leadership as a political cause. Prompt questions to groups: “Which of your causes would make the ruling elite resist reform? Where is the crisis visible?” After 10 minutes bring class back and ask two groups to read their recorder sentence (1 minute each).

Board: Draw a simple 4-box chart labeled: Long-term: Social / Economic. Short-term: Financial / Political. As groups report, write a one-line example under the matching box: e.g. under Social write 'Unequal estates', under Economic write 'Bread prices & poverty', under Financial write 'State debt', under Political write 'Louis XVI indecision'.

- Anticipate: What counts as long-term vs short-term? — Long-term are problems that built up over decades; short-term are pressures in the 1780s that pushed the crisis into open conflict.
- Anticipate: Do we have to agree on which cause was most important? — No. Historians disagree; your sentence should explain which you think mattered most and why.
- Anticipate: Should we use dates or events as evidence? — Use both: a date helps fix when a crisis happened; an event shows how people reacted.

30-35 min: Check for understanding (quick quiz and address misconceptions)

Say: “Two quick checks. First, on a mini whiteboard or scrap paper write the start and end dates and their events from memory. Second, answer: name one long-term cause and one short-term cause.” Give 90 seconds. Then ask a few students to hold up answers. Correct any stubborn mistakes: if someone wrote 1815 for the end, say: “1815 is a date some people use but our class definition gives 9 November 1799 (Coups of 18 Brumaire) as the commonly given end — that is the phrasing in our source.”

Board: Write the two check questions on the board briefly: (1) 'Start & end (date + event)?' (2) 'One long-term cause + one short-term cause?'.

- Anticipate: Why does the lesson insist on 1799 if some people say 1815? — Because the document we use defines the commonly given start and end as 1789 and 1799; historians

offer alternative end points for different reasons.

- Anticipate: If I get the dates wrong, will I fail? — You need to be able to recall the commonly given dates and the document phrasing for this unit.

35-40 min: Consolidate & bridge to next lesson

Say: “To finish, copy the two sentences from the board into your notes exactly — the definition and the causes overview. Then write one sentence: which end date did you think before today, and has your view changed? (One line).” Wait while students copy. Close with: “Next lesson we study the Estates-General and the National Assembly — the event we used as the Revolution’s start. Bring your notes to class.”

Board: Rewrite the exact definition line and the causes sentence once more as a copy prompt. Add a final note: 'Next: Estates-General & National Assembly'.

- Anticipate: Do we have to hand in the one-line reflection? — No, keep it with your notes; I may collect some for quick feedback.
- Anticipate: Will we study the alternative end dates later? — Yes, we'll encounter other interpretations as we study key events.

Blackboard Notes

- Definition — French Revolution
- Causes (overview)
- Examples of causes
- Checks (do now)
- The French Revolution was a period of political and societal change in France that began with the Estates General of 1789 and ended with the Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799.
- The Revolution resulted from multiple long-term and short-term social, economic, financial and political factors culminating in crisis in the late 1780s; resistance to reform by the ruling elite and indecisive policy by Louis XVI contributed.
- Long-term (social): Unequal estates (First, Second, Third Estate).
- Long-term (economic): Poverty, rising bread prices.
- Short-term (financial): State debt and fiscal crisis.
- Short-term (political): Resistance by ruling elite; Louis XVI's indecisive policy.
- Common alternative end dates exist (e.g., 1793, 1815) — historians disagree.
- Diagram: Simple timeline: mark 1789 — 'Estates General (commonly given start)'; mark 9 Nov 1799 — 'Coup of 18 Brumaire (commonly given end)'; optional arrows to show 'other end dates: 1793, 1815' placed below the timeline.
- Diagram: 4-box chart labeled: Long-term: Social | Long-term: Economic | Short-term: Financial | Short-term: Political. Add one short example in each box.

Activities

Two-Minute Claim: When Did the French Revolution Happen? (15 min, debate)

Materials: One short printed excerpt of the provided document per pair (teacher prepares a one-paragraph extract that includes the definition sentence and the causes overview), One sticky note per student, A visible timer or stopwatch (phone or classroom timer), Whiteboard or chart paper and marker

- Before class, print one copy of the document excerpt that contains the exact phrasing of

the definition and causes. Arrange students in pairs and give one copy to each pair.

- Explain the task to the whole class: say, 'You will hold a two-minute mini-debate inside your pair. One student will argue that the French Revolution should be defined exactly as the document phrases it (start: Estates General 1789; end: Coup of 18 Brumaire, 9 November 1799). The other student will argue that this definition is incomplete or needs context (pointing to multiple causes and elite resistance). Each speaker has 1 minute. Then you will write a 1-sentence citation on a sticky note.'
- While pairs debate, circulate and time rounds. Signal when the first minute ends so students switch roles. After both minutes, tell pairs to spend one minute writing a one-sentence citation on the sticky note that uses a phrase from the excerpt to support either claim.
- Collect three strong sticky-note citations to read aloud. Ask two quick class-wide follow-up questions (30 seconds each): 'What phrase from the text gives the start and end dates?' and 'Which short-term and long-term causes does the excerpt mention?' Record brief student answers on the board.

Student instructions:

- Read the short document excerpt at your table (one copy per pair). Notice the sentence that defines the French Revolution and the sentences that list causes.
- Decide with your partner who will be Speaker A and who will be Speaker B.
- Speaker A (1 minute): Argue that the best definition of the French Revolution is the document's phrasing (name the start and end dates exactly as written). Quote the phrase that gives those dates.
- Speaker B (1 minute): Argue that the document's definition needs more context about causes (mention at least one long-term and one short-term cause named in the excerpt and explain why that matters).
- After both speakers, together write one sentence on a sticky note that cites a phrase from the excerpt to support either the definition (dates) or the causes (choose one). Hand the sticky note to the teacher when asked.

Success looks like: Pairs switch speakers after one minute and both students speak for the allotted time (teacher observes timer and role change).; Each pair's sticky note includes a direct phrase from the excerpt: either the clause naming 'Estates General of 1789' and 'Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799' or a short phrase naming 'social, economic, financial and political factors' (teacher inspects notes).; At least three students can quickly point to and read aloud the phrase in the document that gives the start and end dates when asked by the teacher.

Support: If you get stuck, use this sentence frame: 'The document says the Revolution began with _____ and ended with _____, which shows _____.' One worked example: 'The document says the Revolution began with the Estates General of 1789 and ended with the Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799, which shows the author uses these events as start and end dates.' If you need more support, pair a weaker reader with a stronger reader for the debate.

Extension: Challenge: After writing your one-sentence citation, add one extra sticky note answering this question in one sentence: 'Which interpretation is stronger: that the Revolution is best defined by start/end events, or that it is best defined by the mix of causes and processes? Use two phrases from the excerpt as evidence and explain why they point to your choice.'

Checkpoint Questions

- [remember] According to the document, what are the commonly given start and end points (events and dates) of the French Revolution?

Expected: The Revolution is said to have begun with the Estates General of 1789 and ended with the Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799. A correct answer names both events and the end date 9 November 1799 and repeats the phrasing that it "began with the Estates General of 1789 and ended with the Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799."

- [understand] List two long-term causes and one short-term cause of the Revolution described in the document.

Expected: Two long-term causes: (any two of) social inequality in the estates system, economic strain on peasants and urban poor, a chronic financial crisis from debt and war, and political resistance to reform by the elite. One short-term cause: a late-1780s crisis that made the problems acute (for example immediate financial collapse, failed reform attempts, or a specific fiscal emergency). The answer should name these causes and label which are long-term and which is short-term.

- [apply] Give one clear example that shows the difference between a long-term cause and a short-term cause in this context.

Expected: Example: Long-term cause — the estates system and entrenched social inequality built up over centuries, producing deep resentment. Short-term cause — the financial crisis of the late 1780s that suddenly made the government unable to pay debts and forced calls for the Estates General in 1789. The student must explain why the first developed over a long period and why the second was an immediate trigger.

EXIT TICKET

Write one sentence that recalls the commonly given start and end dates of the French Revolution and quote the exact phrasing the document uses.

Success indicator: The response names the Estates General of 1789 as the start and the Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799 as the end, and includes the document's phrase: "began with the Estates General of 1789 and ended with the Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799."

Homework

- Write a one-page (about 6 sentences) summary that defines the French Revolution using the document's dates and phrasing, and list at least three causes (label each as long-term or short-term).
- Prepare two questions you want answered about the Estates-General or the Storming of the Bastille to bring to the next lesson (one factual, one about causes or perspective).

Estimated time: 30 min

MENTOR MOMENT — WHY DATES AND CAUSES CAN FEEL MESSY

A historian I read once spent weeks deciding whether to use 1789 or 1792 as the Revolution's 'real' start — in the end she taught the common dates but explained the debate to students so they knew dates are choices, not facts of nature.

Takeaway: Use the standard dates in class, but remember historians debate boundaries and causes; say the dates and also be ready to explain why people disagree.

Period 2

ENTRY TICKET

Write one sentence answering: Who called the Estates-General in 1789 and why? If you are unsure, write the short reason you think fits.

Expected response: A short sentence naming the monarch (King Louis XVI) and saying it was called to deal with a fiscal crisis (money problems). Responses that name other groups (like the National Assembly) or say it met regularly will show misunderstanding.

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Collect entry tickets & expose misconceptions

Quickly collect the one-sentence tickets. Read aloud 2 or 3 anonymous examples that show common answers: one correct (e.g. "King Louis XVI called it because France had a fiscal crisis") and one incorrect (e.g. "The National Assembly called it" or "It met every few years"). Say: "We will keep the correct parts of these answers and fix the incorrect parts together. Today we will track a short sequence: the Estates-General in May 1789, the National Assembly in June, the Storming of the Bastille on 14 July, and the Assembly's August Decrees. Our goal is to explain how social, economic and political factors led to the Estates-General being called and to the Assembly's radical measures." Pause to let students nod or ask a quick clarifying question.

Board: Write two example sentences from tickets (one correct, one incorrect) so students can see the difference.

- Anticipate: Wasn't the Estates-General always meeting? (No — it last met in 1614 before 1789.)
- Anticipate: Did the National Assembly call the Estates-General? (No — the king summoned the Estates-General.)
- Anticipate: Why pick fiscal crisis as the reason? (Because the primary source and our text say it was summoned to resolve a fiscal crisis.)

5-15 min: Introduce sequence and key definitions

Say: "I will draw a simple timeline and give three definitions from our text. Copy them exactly." Draw the timeline across the board with the labeled points. Read each definition aloud and then ask students to repeat the key phrase. Definitions to read exactly: Estates-General: 'A representative body that last met in 1614 and was summoned to resolve fiscal crisis; its 1789 convening led to debates over voting by estate vs by head.' National Assembly: 'The body constituted when the Third Estate declared itself to be the National Assembly of France and began to verify representatives and claim authority in June 1789.' August Decrees: 'Legislation published by the Assembly that abolished feudalism, cancelled church tithes, and enacted equality before the law and other measures.' After reading, point to each timeline point and say the short date/phrase: 'May 1789 — Estates-General convened; June 1789 — Third Estate becomes National Assembly; 14 July 1789 — Storming of the Bastille; August 1789 — August Decrees.' Ask: "Which of these is a law? Which is an event?" and wait briefly for answers.

Board: Draw a horizontal timeline. Label four points: 'May 1789: Estates-General convened'; 'June 1789: National Assembly declared by Third Estate'; '14 July 1789: Storming of the Bastille'; 'August 1789: August Decrees (abolished feudalism, cancelled tithes, equality before law)'. Underneath, write the three definitions verbatim.

- Anticipate: What does 'verify representatives' mean? (It means confirming who actually

represented each place/person — the Assembly checked who had authority to speak.)

- Anticipate: What does 'voting by estate vs by head' mean? (Voting by estate meant each estate had one vote; voting by head meant counting each representative individually.)
- Anticipate: Did the August Decrees happen right after the Bastille? (They followed in August after the July events and pressure on the Assembly.)

15-25 min: Paired source analysis: causes that led to the Estates-General

Hand out a short page with three prompts tied to the text: (A) Find one economic reason in our notes that would make the king call the Estates-General; (B) Find one political issue in the text that made the Estates-General's voting rules controversial; (C) Find one social pressure from the notes that would push deputies to act. Tell pairs: "You have eight minutes to find one line or phrase from our on-board definitions/timeline that supports each prompt. Write the exact phrase or the board location. Choose one pair to share each answer." Circulate, prompt struggling pairs with: "Look at the definition of Estates-General for fiscal crisis" or "Which estate would want voting by head?" After eight minutes, call on 3 pairs to read their found phrases aloud.

Board: Write the three prompts A, B, C on the board beneath the timeline so students can copy them.

- Anticipate: Is 'fiscal crisis' only about debt? (Students may ask; answer: it mainly refers to money problems the king could not solve without new taxation or approval from representatives.)
- Anticipate: Which estate is the Third Estate? (Explain: commoners — lawyers, merchants, peasants — not the clergy or nobility.)
- Anticipate: Why would voting method matter? (Because it determined who could control decisions; voting by estate gave clergy and nobility more power.)

25-35 min: Small-group role-play debate: July pressure on the Assembly

Divide students into groups of four. Assign roles in each group: two deputies from the Third Estate, one noble deputy, one clergy deputy. Give them this prompt to discuss for six minutes: "After the Bastille (14 July), the Assembly faces pressure to act. The Third Estate deputies want radical change; nobles want limited reform; clergy worry about their tithes. Each speaker has one minute to state their demand and one minute to respond to another deputy." Play the first example yourself with volunteers: as teacher, read a Third Estate line: 'We demand verification of representatives and equality before the law.' Then invite a noble line and a clergy response. After six minutes ask groups to pick one short sentence to report back about what pressure the Assembly faced to publish the August Decrees.

Board: Write the role names and the one-sentence reporting prompt: 'In one sentence, what pressure did your group say pushed the Assembly to abolish feudalism/tithes/equality measures?'

- Anticipate: Can peasants be Third Estate deputies? (Clarify: deputies often came from the educated or propertied Third Estate, but they represented broader Third Estate interests.)
- Anticipate: Did the Bastille free important prisoners? (Students may think famous prisoners were freed; correct gently: the Bastille was symbolically important and its fall increased pressure on Paris and the Assembly.)
- Anticipate: Who actually wrote the August Decrees? (Students may ask who authored them; say: they were published by the Assembly in response to pressure and debate.)

35-38 min: Check for understanding

Use a quick three-question exit check on the board and have students write answers on a slip: 1)

Who summoned the Estates-General and why? 2) What change did the Third Estate make in June 1789? 3) Name two things the August Decrees did. Collect slips. Read one or two aloud to confirm accuracy and correct any remaining error.

Board: Write the three exit questions clearly and number them 1–3.

- Anticipate: Do we need to remember exact dates? (Answer: remember May 1789 for Estates-General and 14 July 1789 for Bastille; August 1789 for the Decrees.)
- Anticipate: Is 'abolished feudalism' the same as ending all noble privileges? (Clarify: the August Decrees abolished feudal dues and many privileges, as the board phrase says.)

38-40 min: Consolidate and link forward

Summarize aloud: 'Quick recap: King summoned the Estates-General to solve a fiscal crisis in May 1789. The Third Estate declared itself the National Assembly in June and claimed authority. The Storming of the Bastille on 14 July pushed the Assembly toward radical action. In August the Assembly published the August Decrees abolishing feudalism, cancelling tithes, and enacting equality before the law.' Then say: 'Next lesson we'll see how these changes affected the Church and the monarchy.' Point to the timeline and definitions and dismiss.

Board: Underline the timeline points and circle the key words in each definition: 'fiscal crisis', 'verify representatives', 'abolished feudalism, cancelled tithes, equality before the law.'

- Anticipate: Will we study the Civil Constitution of the Clergy next? (Yes — that's the next period.)
- Anticipate: Does equality before the law mean everyone was equal right away? (Explain: the law declared equality in many areas, but social and political change took longer and were contested.)

Blackboard Notes

- Timeline: Estates-General -> August Decrees
- Key definitions (copy exactly)
- Paired prompts
- Role-play reporting prompt
- Exit check (answer on slip)
- May 1789: Estates-General convened
- June 1789: Third Estate declares itself the National Assembly
- 14 July 1789: Storming of the Bastille
- August 1789: August Decrees — abolished feudalism, cancelled church tithes, enacted equality before the law
- Estates-General: A representative body that last met in 1614 and was summoned to resolve fiscal crisis; its 1789 convening led to debates over voting by estate vs by head.
- National Assembly: The body constituted when the Third Estate declared itself to be the National Assembly of France and began to verify representatives and claim authority in June 1789.
- August Decrees: Legislation published by the Assembly that abolished feudalism, cancelled church tithes, and enacted equality before the law and other measures.
- Paired prompts: A) One economic reason for calling the Estates-General. B) One political issue about voting by estate vs by head. C) One social pressure pushing deputies to act.
- Role-play report: 'In one sentence, what pressure did your group say pushed the Assembly to abolish feudalism/tithes/equality measures?'

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Exit check: 1) Who summoned the Estates-General and why? 2) What change did the Third Estate make in June 1789? 3) Name two things the August Decrees did.

- Diagram: Horizontal timeline with four labelled points: May 1789; June 1789; 14 July 1789; August 1789.
- Diagram: A small three-column box under 'Paired prompts' labeled Economic | Political | Social for pairs to jot one line each.

Activities

Three Moments, One Crisis: Small-Group Evidence Discussion (10 min, group_discussion)

Materials: One copy per group of a short evidence sheet (teacher prints 1 page with three short excerpts: Estates-General call, eyewitness line about Bastille, text of an August Decree clause) — teacher can prepare in 10 minutes, Timer or stopwatch, One sheet of scrap paper and a pen per group

1. Arrange students in groups of 3. Hand each group the evidence sheet, one scrap paper, and tell them they have 8 minutes for the task. Start the timer and say: "You will read three short excerpts about 1789. Decide together: which social, economic or political factor does each excerpt best show? Then pick one excerpt and explain how it helped move France from Estates-General to the August Decrees."
2. While groups work, circulate. Pause any group after 4 minutes and ask one probing question aloud to the class (rotate each round): "Which factor —social, economic, or political— is strongest in that excerpt?" Do not give answers; only prompt groups that are stuck to use the sentence frames on the support slip.
3. With 1 minute remaining, tell groups to choose one speaker to give a 30-second summary to the class. When time is up, call two groups to each give their 30-second summary (total 1 minute).
4. After the two summaries, ask a final 30-second whole-class question: "Which excerpt could be interpreted more than one way? Give a one-sentence reason." Collect one scrap paper from each group as their evidence-based claim.

Student instructions:

1. In your group of three, read the three short excerpts on the evidence sheet together.
2. For each excerpt, decide which kind of factor it best shows: social (religion, class, privileges), economic (taxes, debt, food prices), or political (representation, royal power, law). Write the factor word next to that excerpt on your scrap paper.
3. Choose one excerpt and write one clear sentence that explains how that excerpt helped move events from the Estates-General toward the August Decrees (use facts from the excerpt).
4. Pick one person to speak for 30 seconds to tell the class your chosen excerpt and your one-sentence explanation.

Success looks like: Each group labels all three excerpts with one of the categories: social, economic, or political.; Each group writes a one-sentence explanation that links a specific detail from an excerpt to a step between the Estates-General and the August Decrees.; Two groups deliver a 30-second summary that mentions the excerpt and the claimed causal link (e.g., 'Because X in this excerpt shows Y, the National Assembly responded by Z').

Support: Provide a sentence frame on the evidence sheet: "This excerpt shows (social/economic/political) factor because _____. That helped cause _____, so the Assembly _____." For groups who need more help, assign a stronger reader as speaker and reduce the task to labeling only two excerpts and writing one sentence about one of them.

Extension: Ask students who finish early to identify one detail in an excerpt that could support a competing interpretation (for example, an excerpt showing popular violence could also be read as evidence of elite fear). Write a short note explaining the two interpretations and which evidence would best decide between them.

Checkpoint Questions

- [understand] In one sentence, what decision by the Third Estate changed the structure of representation in June 1789?

Expected: They declared themselves the National Assembly, breaking from the Estates-General to verify representatives and claim authority; this shifted representation from estate-based voting to a body claiming national authority.

- [understand] Give one specific consequence of the Storming of the Bastille on the actions of the National Assembly.

Expected: The Bastille's fall (14 July 1789) pressured the Assembly into radical measures, helping create momentum for the August Decrees and other reforms; it made the Assembly respond to popular violence with legal changes.

- [understand] Name two measures included in the August Decrees and explain briefly why they were significant.

Expected: They abolished feudalism and cancelled church tithes (and enacted equality before the law). These were significant because they removed legal privileges of the nobility and reduced the church's economic power, changing social and legal structures.

EXIT TICKET

Using evidence from the period's material, explain in a short paragraph how social, economic, and political factors combined to create the crisis that led to calling the Estates-General in 1789.

Success indicator: A correct response names at least one social factor (e.g., inequality of estates or popular discontent), one economic factor (e.g., fiscal crisis, debt, or taxation like tithes), and one political factor (e.g., dispute over voting by estate vs by head or lack of representative solution), and links each factor briefly to why it made the king summon the Estates-General.

Homework

- Write a one-page paragraph (about 150–200 words) that cites two pieces of evidence from the period to support why the Third Estate declared the National Assembly.
- Create a two-column note: left column list the August Decrees' main measures (at least three); right column list the immediate effect each measure would have on social or legal privilege.
- Find one short primary-source quotation (class reader or teacher handout) from July–August 1789 and write two sentences explaining how it reflects popular pressure on the Assembly.

Estimated time: 40 min

MENTOR MOMENT — WHEN A CROWD CHANGES A MEETING

A mayor I knew once reopened a council meeting after residents gathered outside and refused to leave; the mayor listened and changed the agenda so the crowd's issue was debated that night.

Takeaway: Public pressure can force political bodies to act quickly; in 1789 the Bastille and crowds pushed the Assembly to make bigger changes than it planned.

Period 3

ENTRY TICKET

Circle one event and write one sentence: which event most damaged Louis XVI's reputation among ordinary people — A) Storming of the Bastille (July 1789), B) Civil Constitution of the Clergy (July 1790), or C) Flight to Varennes (June 1791)? Briefly say why you chose it.

Expected response: Correct choice: C) Flight to Varennes. A good sentence will say the king tried to leave France, which looked like betrayal and made people doubt he would accept the Revolution. If students pick A or B, it shows they think early popular actions or church changes directly targeted the king rather than later royal behaviour.

Teacher Script

0-1 min: Collect entry tickets and set purpose

Collect the entry tickets quickly. Say: 'Thanks — keep your sentence short. Today we will trace what happened after the August Decrees: how a constitutional monarchy was built, why it started falling apart, and which events pushed France toward a republic.'

Board: Write the lesson question at top of board: 'How did the constitutional monarchy rise and then collapse?'

- Anticipate: Do we have to hand this in? (Yes — I'll skim them for common ideas.)
- Anticipate: Will today cover the king's trial? (Not today — that comes after we study the fall of the monarchy.)

1-12 min: Introduce new material: key changes in the constitutional monarchy

Say: 'We will build a short timeline and three facts you must remember.' Draw the timeline example: write May 1789, July 1789, 12 July 1790, June 1791, 10 August 1792, September 1792. Point to each date as you speak. For each of the three concept bullets below, read the text sentence, then ask the class: "What does that mean for ordinary people?" Pause for one or two 10–15 second answers, then give the evidence-based sentence.

- Read: 'Constitutional monarchy period (July 1789–3 Sep 1792): the Revolution created a constitution and limited political rights to "active citizens."' Ask: 'Who could vote under the constitution?' Wait for answers (expect: property owners). Then say: 'Right — the new system kept many political rights tied to property and paid tax; that limited who shaped laws.'

- Read: 'Civil Constitution of the Clergy; confiscation of church property (12 July 1790).' Ask: 'What problem did confiscation try to solve?' Wait. Then say: 'The Assembly used church land and assignats to pay state debts. That helped finance the state but divided the Church because priests became state employees and had to swear an oath.'

- Read: 'Flight to Varennes (June 1791) discredited the monarchy.' Ask: 'Why would a king leaving the country change public trust?' Wait. Then say: 'The king appeared to abandon the Revolution. That increased suspicion and led Republicans and moderates to demand stricter controls and oaths.'

Board: On the timeline, label: 'Constitutional monarchy (Jul 1789–3 Sep 1792)'. Under 12 July 1790 write: 'Civil Constitution of the Clergy; church property confiscated -> assignats'. Under June 1791 write: 'Flight to Varennes -> loss of trust in king'.

- Anticipate: What is an 'active citizen'? (Someone who paid a certain tax or met property requirements — the constitution limited political rights by wealth.)

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Anticipate: What are assignats? (Paper money backed by confiscated church land — we will use the worked example later.)

- Anticipate: Did all priests have to accept the Civil Constitution? (No — it divided the clergy into those who swore the oath and those who refused.)

12-25 min: Role play: perspectives on the Civil Constitution and the king's flight

Split the class into three quick groups: Group A = urban merchants/property owners (active citizens), Group B = parish priests (non-juring or jurors), Group C = ordinary peasants. Tell each group: 'You have two minutes to prepare a one-line opinion about the Civil Constitution and a one-line opinion about the king's Flight to Varennes. You must speak as if you live then.' Give a clear example: for Group A say: 'We are property owners; we might like the constitution because it protects our vote.' For Group B say: 'We are priests; decide whether you took the oath or refused and why.' For Group C say: 'We are peasants; think about bread prices and assignats and say whether you feel safer.' After two minutes, call one speaker from each group and have them deliver their two lines. After each trio of lines, ask: 'Which of the three felt most betrayed by the king? Which by the Assembly?'

Board: Draw three labeled boxes: 'Active citizens', 'Priests', 'Peasants'. Under each, write one student-supplied example line from each group as they speak.

- Anticipate: Can we say different things than our group's label suggests? (Try to speak from the group's likely interests — that's the point of perspective-taking.)
- Anticipate: What if our group disagrees inside? (Pick the most common view in your group to report.)
- Anticipate: Do assignats affect everyone the same? (No — they hurt people on fixed incomes more and made prices unstable.)

25-32 min: Group discussion: competing interpretations of why the monarchy fell

Say: 'We will test two competing explanations. Explanation 1: Structural changes and economic policy (confiscation, assignats, and 'active citizens') made the system unstable. Explanation 2: The king's own actions (Flight to Varennes and secret dealings) destroyed trust and pushed people toward republic. Take 2 minutes to note which explanation you agree with and one piece of evidence from today. Then we'll take quick reports.' Give a 30-second model response: 'I choose Explanation 2: Flight to Varennes — evidence: the king tried to leave, which led to demands for oaths and more suspicion.' Call on 4 volunteers to state explanation and evidence (15–20 seconds each). After each, say one sentence tying their evidence back to the timeline.

Board: Create two columns headed 'Structural/economic' and 'King's actions'. Under each, write 1–2 student examples as they are offered (e.g., 'assignats -> inflation' under Structural; 'Varennes -> loss of trust' under King's actions).

- Anticipate: Can both explanations be true? (Yes — the class should see how multiple causes combine.)
- Anticipate: Which side do historians prefer? (Different historians stress different causes; we are showing competing interpretations from the text.)

32-38 min: Check for understanding (quick written task)

Hand out or ask students to write for three minutes: 'In two sentences, explain how the Civil Constitution of the Clergy and the Flight to Varennes worked together to weaken the monarchy.' Circulate and read a few answers aloud. End with: 'A strong answer will mention: church land confiscated -> assignats and division in the Church; and the king's flight -> loss of legitimacy,

which together increased calls for stronger measures and prepared the way for the 10 August insurrection.'

Board: Write the checklist for a good answer: 1) mention confiscation/assignats, 2) mention Civil Constitution dividing clergy, 3) mention Flight to Varennes undermining king, 4) tie to increased unrest leading to 10 Aug 1792.

- Anticipate: How long should the two sentences be? (Short and direct — two clear sentences.)
- Anticipate: Do we have to mention dates? (Mentioning '1790' or '1791' helps but focus on cause-and-effect.)

38-40 min: Consolidate and preview next period

Say: 'Quick wrap-up: The Revolution tried to make a constitutional monarchy. Economic moves and church reforms changed society; the king's flight deepened distrust. These combined pressures led to the insurrection of 10 August 1792 and the end of the monarchy, which we will study next in detail. For homework: re-read the worked example on assignats and bring one question about how money affected politics.'

Board: Write homework: 'Read: worked example — assignats & inflation. Bring 1 question.'

- Anticipate: Is the insurrection of 10 August the same day the monarchy fell? (It was the key event that led to the king's suspension and later the Republic in Sep 1792.)
- Anticipate: Will we study the king's trial next? (Yes — that comes after we cover the Republic's proclamation.)

Blackboard Notes

- How did the constitutional monarchy rise and then collapse?
- Timeline (key dates)
- Two interpretations: structural/economic vs. king's actions
- Checklist for the 2-sentence answer
- Homework
- Timeline: May 1789 -> Estates General; July 1789 -> National Assembly & Bastille; 12 July 1790 -> Civil Constitution of the Clergy; June 1791 -> Flight to Varennes; 10 Aug 1792 -> Insurrection; Sep 1792 -> First Republic
- Constitutional monarchy (Jul 1789–3 Sep 1792): constitution created; political rights limited to 'active citizens' (property/tax requirement)
- Civil Constitution of the Clergy (12 July 1790): church lands confiscated to back assignats; clergy became state employees; required oath — split the Church
- Assignats & inflation (worked example): confiscation -> assignats issued; excessive issue + poor harvests -> rising prices and economic stress
- Flight to Varennes (June 1791): king's attempted escape -> lost public trust; increased calls for oaths and tougher measures
- Insurrection of 10 August 1792: military defeats + political unrest -> attack on the monarchy; replacement by Republic in Sep 1792
- Two interpretations to weigh: 1) Structural/economic causes (assignats, limits on active citizens, church policy) 2) King's actions (Varennes, secret deals) — both can combine
- Checklist for good answer: 1) Mention confiscation/assignats 2) Mention Civil Constitution dividing clergy 3) Mention Flight to Varennes undermining king 4) Connect to unrest / 10 Aug 1792

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Homework: Read worked example — assignats & inflation. Bring 1 question.

- Diagram: Horizontal timeline with the five key dates labeled and short notes under each date.
- Diagram: Three-column boxes titled 'Active citizens', 'Priests', 'Peasants' with one example reaction written under each.
- Diagram: Two-column table: 'Structural/economic' vs 'King's actions' with one bullet under each (e.g., 'assignats -> inflation' and 'Varennes -> loss of trust').

Activities

Debate at the Tuileries: Who Should Swear the Oath? (12 min, role_play)

Materials: 3 index cards labeled 'Constitutional Clergy (oath supporters)', 3 index cards labeled 'Non-juring Clergy (refusers)', 3 index cards labeled 'Active Citizens / National Guards', 3 index cards labeled 'Royalists / King's Household', 1 clock or stopwatch, 1 printed short evidence slip per role (teacher prepares 1 paragraph each, see teacher step 2), chalkboard or whiteboard and marker

- 1. Arrange students into 12 small groups of 3–4. Tell them each group will role-play one of four perspectives: Constitutional Clergy, Non-juring Clergy, Active Citizens/National Guard, or Royalists. Distribute the labeled index cards so each role is covered by at least three groups. Say: "You have 12 minutes to prepare and perform a 2-minute role-play showing your group's response to the requirement that clergy swear the Civil Constitution of the Clergy and how the king's flight and recent defeats affect your trust in the monarchy."
- 2. Hand each group a printed evidence slip (one paragraph) tailored to their role. Each slip must contain one factual sentence from the period (e.g., date of the Civil Constitution of the Clergy: 12 July 1790; that church property was confiscated to back assignats; that Louis XVI attempted to flee in June 1791; that 10 August 1792 was an insurrection leading to the monarchy's fall). Instruct groups to use that sentence as a piece of evidence in their role-play and to include one opposing interpretation (a brief line suggesting why another group might disagree).
- 3. Give groups 6 minutes to plan: one student will speak for 90 seconds in the performance, others will add a 30-second rebuttal line. While they plan, circulate and check each group's evidence slip is used in a complete sentence and that they include one specific reference to either confiscation of church property/assignats, the Civil Constitution (12 July 1790), the Flight to Varennes (June 1791), or the Insurrection of 10 August 1792. Prompt with questions if a group stalls (e.g., "How does the king's flight change your trust?").
- 4. Run performances: call groups in role order so contrasting perspectives are adjacent (for example: Constitutional Clergy, Non-juring Clergy, Active Citizens, Royalists, then repeat). Time each performance: 2 minutes per group (90-second statement + 30-second rebuttal). After each group, ask one quick clarifying question aloud (e.g., "Which specific action from 1791 or 1792 most influenced your position?") and move on.
- 5. Close with a 90-second whole-class wrap: write three headlines on the board from students' plays that show (a) how confiscation and the Civil Constitution divided opinion, (b) how the Flight to Varennes damaged the monarchy's credibility, and (c) how these divisions helped lead to the Insurrection of 10 August 1792 and the Republic. Collect the evidence slips.

Student instructions:

- You are in a 3–4 person group assigned one historical role: Constitutional Clergy (support

oath), Non-juring Clergy (refuse oath), Active Citizens/National Guard, or Royalists/King's Household.

- Read the evidence slip your teacher gives you. Your group must: (1) include that factual sentence exactly once in your spoken lines as evidence, (2) state your position about the clergy oath and the king's actions, and (3) include one short line acknowledging why another role might reasonably disagree.
- Plan a 90-second main speech that uses the evidence slip to support your view, and prepare a 30-second rebuttal reacting to an imagined opposing point (your teacher will time you). Speak in role; give reasons that link social, economic, and political factors: mention confiscation/assignats or the Civil Constitution (12 July 1790), the Flight to Varennes (June 1791), or the Insurrection of 10 August 1792 where appropriate.
- Perform when your group is called: one person speaks the main statement, others add the rebuttal. Use clear evidence language like 'On 12 July 1790 the Assembly...' or 'After the Flight to Varennes in June 1791...' and end with a one-sentence claim about whether the monarchy can be trusted.

Success looks like: Each performing group says the factual sentence from their evidence slip aloud during their 90-second statement.; Observers hear at least one explicit connection in each performance between a specific event (Civil Constitution 12 July 1790, confiscation/assignats, Flight to Varennes June 1791, or Insurrection 10 August 1792) and the group's position.; In each group's rebuttal a student acknowledges at least one plausible opposing interpretation (for example, a Constitutional Cleric names why Non-juring Clergy fear state control). Support: Pair a student who struggles with a stronger reader; give the struggling student this sentence frame to use in the speech: 'On [date/event] the Assembly did X (evidence). Because of that, my group believes Y. We also understand that others say Z, but we respond...'. If time is tight, reduce the performance to 60 seconds (45s statement, 15s rebuttal).

Extension: After performing, write a one-paragraph note as your role advising a member of the National Convention (fall 1792). Use at least two pieces of evidence from the slips to recommend a specific policy (for example, how to handle church property or how to treat the former king) and explain how your recommendation anticipates political consequences.

Checkpoint Questions

- [understand] Explain in one sentence how the Civil Constitution of the Clergy changed the church's role in France and why it caused division.

Expected: The Civil Constitution made clergy state employees and required an oath to the Revolution, which removed church independence and split clergy and believers into those who swore the oath and those who refused, creating political and social conflict.

- [understand] Describe briefly how the Flight to Varennes affected people's trust in Louis XVI and one political consequence that followed.

Expected: The Flight to Varennes showed the king trying to escape, which discredited him and made people suspect he opposed the Revolution; as a result, demands for loyalty oaths increased and support for restricting or removing the monarchy grew.

- [understand] Using two examples from the period July 1789–September 1792, explain how political and military events combined to produce the insurrection of 10 August 1792.

Expected: Political limits on rights (active citizens only) and the king's weakened position after Varennes reduced royal legitimacy, while military defeats and fear of counter-revolution increased public anger; together these political grievances and military failures helped trigger the insurrection on 10 August 1792.

EXIT TICKET

In a short paragraph (3–5 sentences), explain how social, economic and political factors combined to create a crisis that led to the calling of the Estates-General in 1789. Use at least one specific piece of evidence named in the period (for example: assignats, Civil Constitution, Flight to Varennes, active citizens).

Success indicator: The answer names social, economic and political causes; links them (e.g., social inequality, economic strain from poor harvests/inflation and assignats, political limits such as 'active citizens' or royal authority); and includes at least one specific piece of evidence from the period that supports the connection (for example: confiscation -> assignats -> inflation, or limited political rights -> demand for Estates-General).

Homework

- Write a one-page (about 250 words) paragraph that traces the sequence from the confiscation of church property to the problem of assignat inflation. Include at least two causes and one consequence and cite the period's examples.
- Find and bring to class one short primary-source quote (1–3 sentences) from 1789–1792 that shows public distrust of the king or clergy. Be ready to explain in one sentence why it supports your paragraph.

Estimated time: 40 min

MENTOR MOMENT — WHEN A SMALL DECISION LOSES TRUST

A teacher I worked with asked students to imagine a leader who tried to leave during a crisis; their quick judgment was that escape felt like betrayal, not strategy.

Takeaway: Even a single act that looks like abandoning duties can destroy trust quickly — that loss of trust helps explain why Louis XVI's flight mattered more than his intent.

Period 4

ENTRY TICKET

Circle the date you think marks when France first became a republic: 1789 / 1791 / 1792 / 1793.
Then write one short phrase explaining why you chose that date.

Expected response: Most correct response: 1792 — Because the Convention proclaimed the French First Republic on 22 September 1792 (they replaced the monarchy and declared Year One). Common misconception response: 1789 or 1791 — students often pick 1789 because the Revolution began then, or 1791 because of the new constitution; these answers show confusion between the start of the Revolution, a constitutional monarchy, and the later proclamation of a republic.

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Collect entry tickets & spot-check misconceptions

Quickly collect or have students hold up their entry-ticket answers. Read aloud 2-3 different student phrases: one that picked 1789, one that picked 1791, and one that picked 1792. Say: “We will test these ideas today. Keep your answer — we’ll return to it after our activities.” If a student picked 1792, ask them to read their phrase so the class hears the correct date placed by a peer.

Board: Write on the board: “Entry-ticket: picked 1789 / 1791 / 1792 / 1793 — why?” and underline the responses read aloud.

- Anticipate: Why are there several dates to choose from?
- Anticipate: Isn’t 1789 the start of the Revolution?
- Anticipate: Didn’t the King lose power earlier (like in 1791)?

5-15 min: Introduce the three core facts (Proclamation, Trial & Execution, Committee)

Say: “I will read three short facts. Listen and follow on the board.” Read clearly: “1) On 22 September 1792 the Convention replaced the monarchy with the French First Republic and introduced a new calendar with 1792 as ‘Year One.’ 2) Louis XVI was tried by the Convention, sentenced to death on 17 January 1793, and executed on 21 January 1793. 3) The Committee of Public Safety was created on 6 April 1793; it became the executive committee dominating the Convention and led the government during what became the Reign of Terror.” After reading, ask: “Which of these surprised you?” Point to each date and ask a student to restate one fact in their own words. Then say: “These are facts. Historians debate why these decisions happened — we will look at two different interpretations now.” Briefly present two interpretations: “One view: these were emergency steps to save the Revolution during war and internal threats. Another view: these show how radicals concentrated power and used violence.” Ask: “Which interpretation does the trial and execution of Louis support? Which could the Committee support?” Invite 1-2 short replies.

Board: Write the three dated facts as bullet points (see 'blackboard_notes'). Add a short line under the facts: “Two interpretations: emergency defense vs. radical centralisation.”

- Anticipate: Was the new calendar actually used by everyone?
- Anticipate: Was Louis convicted right away or was there a trial with witnesses?
- Anticipate: What exactly did the Committee of Public Safety do — did it replace the Convention?

15-27 min: Role play & short debate: why execute Louis?

Divide class into three quick groups (assign or have students count off): Jacobins (argue Louis must be executed to protect the Republic), Girondins/moderates (argue against execution — fear of setting a violent precedent), and Neutral/War-council (focus on international war and public order). Give each group 2 minutes to prepare one short statement (one sentence) and one reason from the facts read (use dates or events). Then hold a 6-minute timed debate: each group reads its statement (30 seconds each), then one round of rebuttals (30 seconds each). After debate, ask: “Which arguments pointed to emergency defence? Which pointed to radicalisation?” Debrief: remind students that the Convention voted; read aloud again the sentencing date 17 January and execution date 21 January to anchor the debate in facts.

Board: Draw three labelled boxes: Jacobins / Girondins / Neutral — under each write the one-sentence statements students produce (teacher writes them). Mark: “Vote -> sentence 17 Jan 1793 -> execution 21 Jan 1793.”

- Anticipate: Did ordinary people vote or was it just deputies?
- Anticipate: How many deputies voted for death?
- Anticipate: Was there any chance Louis would have been sent into exile instead?

27-33 min: Group discussion: link events to causes (social, economic, political)

Ask the class: “How do these events (republic proclamation, Louis’s trial and execution, creation of the Committee) connect back to the deeper social, economic and political problems that produced the crisis of 1789?” Prompt with three scaffold questions, one at a time: 1) Social — “How might unequal estates and public anger help explain why deputies felt a republic was possible?” 2) Economic — “How could fiscal crisis and war pressure make harsh decisions seem necessary?” 3) Political — “How did the collapse of trust in the king (Flight to Varennes, 10 August 1792 insurrection) change what options deputies saw?” Call on 3 groups to read one sentence answers from their debate notes or earlier work. Stress evidence: point back to the dates on the board and say “these facts show the speed and stakes.”

Board: Add three short bullets under a new heading: Causes -> Social / Economic / Political, each with one short phrase linking to the events.

- Anticipate: Are we supposed to memorise these causes or argue about them?
- Anticipate: Was the Committee created because of war only?
- Anticipate: Did all regions of France feel the same social pressures?

33-38 min: Check for understanding (quick written prompts)

Hand out or project 3 quick prompts; students have 4 minutes to write one-sentence answers: 1) When was the Republic proclaimed? 2) Give two dates connected to Louis XVI’s trial and execution. 3) What was the Committee of Public Safety and when was it created? Collect answers or have students hold them up. Read a few aloud and correct any errors on the spot. Return to the entry-ticket: ask a student who chose 1789 or 1791 to revise their one-phrase answer in light of what they learned.

Board: Project the 3 prompts on the board (see text above) and write brief correct answers after checking samples.

- Anticipate: Do we need the exact days or just the months/years?
- Anticipate: Can I write the Committee’s role in one sentence?
- Anticipate: What if my answer mixes up the dates?

38-40 min: Consolidate and preview next lesson

Summarise in one sentence: “22 Sept 1792 — Republic proclaimed; Jan 1793 — Louis tried, sentenced 17 Jan, executed 21 Jan; 6 Apr 1793 — Committee of Public Safety set up and later dominated the Convention.” Say: “Next class we will study how the Committee governed and why that led to the Reign of Terror. For homework, read the short source packet pages on the Committee’s creation and note one sentence that supports each interpretation we discussed.” Dismiss.

Board: Underline key dates once more and write: “Homework: read Committee sources; note evidence for emergency vs. radicalisation.”

- Anticipate: How long should the homework take?
- Anticipate: Will the next class focus on violence after the Committee?
- Anticipate: Can I use my class notes for the homework?

Blackboard Notes

- Period 4: Republic Proclamation -> Louis’s Execution -> Committee of Public Safety
- Key Dates
- Two competing interpretations
- Causes (link to 1789 Estates General)
- 22 Sept 1792 — National Convention proclaims the French First Republic; new calendar: 1792 = Year One
- 17 Jan 1793 — Louis XVI sentenced to death by the Convention
- 21 Jan 1793 — Louis XVI executed
- 6 Apr 1793 — Committee of Public Safety created; became the executive committee dominating the Convention during the Reign of Terror
- Two interpretations: (1) Emergency defence in war/insurrection vs. (2) Radical centralisation using violence
- Causes linked to earlier crisis: social inequality (estates), economic/fiscal crisis, political collapse of trust in monarchy -> led to 1789 Estates General and later radical measures
- Diagram: Simple timeline: mark 22 Sep 1792 (Republic proclaimed, Year I), 17 Jan 1793 (sentence), 21 Jan 1793 (execution), 6 Apr 1793 (Committee created); draw arrows showing quick sequence from proclamation -> trial -> Committee
- Diagram: Three-box sketch for role play: Jacobins | Girondins/Moderates | Neutral (War-council) — write one sentence position under each during class

Activities

Gallery Walk: From Republic Proclamation to Louis's Execution (12 min, gallery_walk)

Materials: 4 printed source slips (one per station) — teacher-prepared from textbook or handouts, chart paper or large sticky notes for each station, markers (one per pair), timer or stopwatch, taped signs to mark 4 stations around the room

- Before class: prepare four stations placed around the room. At each station place a printed source slip (see guidance below) and a blank sheet of chart paper with the station number. Station 1: Proclamation of the First Republic (22 Sept 1792). Station 2: Trial and execution of Louis XVI (Jan 1793). Station 3: Creation and role of the Committee of Public Safety (6 Apr 1793). Station 4: Evidence connecting social/economic/political crisis to calling the Estates General (1789).

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Arrange students into pairs and tell them the activity lasts 12 minutes. Explain that pairs will rotate through all four stations spending 2.5 minutes at each station, plus 1 minute at the start for directions and 0.5 minutes buffer. Start the timer and announce rotations aloud.

- When a pair arrives at a station they read the printed source slip and then: (a) write one sentence of factual evidence from the slip on the chart paper, (b) write one short interpretation that connects that evidence to one of the three target concepts (Republic proclamation, Louis's trial/execution, Committee of Public Safety) or to causes leading to the Estates General, and (c) add a one-sentence alternative interpretation or question that challenges the first interpretation. Circulate and prompt pairs who are stuck with one targeted question from the support scaffolds.
- After 12 minutes, call students back to their seats. Spend 4 minutes whole-class: ask 3 different pairs to read one chart entry aloud (one factual evidence, one interpretation, one alternative interpretation). Conclude by reminding students how competing interpretations and evidence link to the objective about causes of 1789; assign follow-up reading as needed.

Student instructions:

- You are in a pair. You will visit four stations for this 12-minute gallery walk. At each station you will have 2.5 minutes.
- At each station do these three things on the chart paper: (1) Copy one clear factual piece of evidence from the printed source slip (one sentence). (2) Write a one-sentence interpretation that explains how that evidence connects to the station's concept (Republic proclamation; Louis's trial/execution; Committee of Public Safety; or causes of the Estates General). Use the phrase "This suggests..." to start your sentence. (3) Write a one-sentence alternative interpretation or a question that challenges your interpretation, starting with "Alternatively..." or "What if...?".
- Rotate when your teacher or the timer signals. Keep your writing large and legible so others can read it. Do not erase others' notes; instead add your own line if a chart already has writing.
- Be ready at the end to share one chart line from a station you visited. Base your sharing on text evidence — say which word or sentence on the source slip supports your interpretation.

Success looks like: At least three stations show one clear factual sentence copied from the printed source slip (teacher can read it while circulating); Most pairs have written an interpretation that begins with "This suggests..." and links the evidence to the stated concept for that station.; At least two stations include an alternative interpretation or question that starts with "Alternatively..." or "What if...?"

Support: Pair students heterogeneously so one stronger reader works with one who needs support. If a pair cannot start, use this sentence frame to begin their chart: "This source says ____ (copy 3–6 words). This suggests that ____ because ____." As a worked first item, at Station 1 write: "Source: '22 September 1792... Year One.' This suggests the Convention wanted a complete break from monarchy because they reset the calendar to Year One. Alternatively: some representatives may have chosen a new calendar to mark legal changes, not only to erase the past."

Extension: Choose one station and write a two-paragraph mini-essay on the chart: first paragraph outlines how the specific event (e.g., Committee of Public Safety) can be seen as a response to immediate threats; second paragraph presents a competing historical interpretation that emphasizes longer-term structural causes (social/economic) and cites at least one piece of evidence from another station to support that interpretation.

Checkpoint Questions

- [understand] What happened on 22 September 1792, and why did the Convention choose to start a new calendar with 1792 as 'Year One'?

Expected: On 22 September 1792 the National Convention abolished the monarchy and proclaimed the French First Republic. They set 1792 as 'Year One' to mark a clear break with the old regime and to symbolise the start of a new political order.

- [understand] Give two reasons the Convention put Louis XVI on trial and state the dates when he was sentenced and executed.

Expected: The Convention tried Louis XVI because he was seen as having betrayed the nation (e.g., Flight to Varennes undermined his legitimacy) and because many deputies believed removing him was necessary for the Republic's security. He was sentenced to death on 17 January 1793 and executed on 21 January 1793.

- [understand] What was the Committee of Public Safety, when was it created, and what role did it soon come to play?

Expected: The Committee of Public Safety was an executive committee created on 6 April 1793 to coordinate the war effort and domestic policy. It soon dominated the Convention and led the government during the Reign of Terror.

EXIT TICKET

In one short paragraph (4–6 sentences), explain how social, economic, and political factors combined to produce the crisis that led to calling the Estates-General in 1789. Use at least one specific piece of evidence mentioned in class (a fact, date, or event).

Success indicator: Paragraph names at least one social factor (e.g., inequality of the Third Estate), one economic factor (e.g., state debt, tax burden, or poor harvests/rising bread prices), and one political factor (e.g., lack of representation, royal authority or noble privileges). It links these factors to a crisis that made the king call the Estates-General and includes one specific piece of class evidence (for example: financial crisis/state debt, the influence of ministers like Necker, or the date 1789/Estates-General).

Homework

- Write a one-page (about 250 words) answer: How did the fall of the monarchy (August 1792) make the proclamation of the Republic in September 1792 more likely? Use at least two facts from class (dates or events).
- Write two discussion questions (one about the trial of Louis XVI and one about the Committee of Public Safety) that you would bring to next class to compare competing interpretations of why these actions happened.

Estimated time: 30 min

MENTOR MOMENT — WHEN ONE DOCUMENT CHANGED A DEBATE

A teacher once showed students a short government ledger that proved the crown's debt was far worse than people expected. The class suddenly stopped arguing in generalities and debated what to do next.

Takeaway: A single clear piece of evidence can change how you understand a crisis — so always look for facts (dates, numbers, events) to test big explanations.

Period 5

ENTRY TICKET

Write one sentence answering: Between 1793 and 1794 many people were arrested and some executed. Which do you think leaders most feared: a) royalists trying to bring back the king, b) ordinary peasants rioting for food, or c) foreign armies invading France? Circle a, b, or c and add one reason for your choice.

Expected response: A short answer circling a, b, or c and one reason. Common incorrect pattern: many students will choose (c) because they think invasion was the main threat; an informed response will note that leaders feared internal opposition (a) and unrest over food and taxation (b) and that the Terror targeted alleged counter-revolution at home.

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Collect entry tickets and set lesson goal

Collect the slips quickly. Read aloud one example that chose (c) and one that chose (a) or (b). Say: "Today we'll try to explain a short sequence: the Reign of Terror, its end in the Thermidorian Reaction, the Directory, and finally the coup of 18 Brumaire which made Napoleon First Consul. We'll look for evidence and competing reasons for why the Terror happened and why it ended." Then write the lesson question on the board: "How did the Terror create instability that led to the Directory and 18 Brumaire?"

Board: Write the lesson question on the board.

- Anticipate: Do we have to hand these back? (Yes, collect them.)
- Anticipate: Will this be graded? (No, it's a quick check.)
- Anticipate: What is 18 Brumaire? (We'll cover that later in the lesson.)

5-15 min: Introduce new material: key facts and timeline

Say: "I will read three short facts. Listen and underline anything new." Read slowly: 1) 'Reign of Terror: A period (Sept 1793 – 3 July 1794) during which revolutionary authorities arrested about 300,000 people and executed some 16,600 on charges of counter-revolutionary activity.' (Point to those numbers as you read.) 2) 'Thermidorian Reaction: the fall of the Terror in July 1794.' 3) 'The Directory replaced the Committee of Public Safety in November 1795 and lasted until 1799 when the coup of 18 Brumaire brought the Consulate and Napoleon as First Consul.' Then ask: "Which of those facts surprises you?" Call on 3 students. Finally, trace the quick timeline on the board from Estates General to Consulate and say each date aloud: May 1789, July 1789, August 1789, August 1792, Sept 1793–July 1794, Nov 1795, 9 Nov 1799 (18 Brumaire).

Board: Write the Reign of Terror definition verbatim and add the three dates for Thermidor/Directory/18

Brumaire; draw a simple horizontal timeline and mark the listed events with dates.

- Anticipate: Are those arrest and execution numbers exact? (They are the figures given by the source; they are approximate counts recorded by revolutionary authorities and historians.)
- Anticipate: Was everyone arrested for the same reason? (No — charges ranged from royalist plots to local disputes framed as counter-revolutionary.)
- Anticipate: Is 18 Brumaire the same as November 9, 1799? (Yes; that's the Revolutionary calendar name for that date.)

15-27 min: Debate / role play: who caused the Terror?

Explain: "We'll split into three short groups. Each group has 3 minutes to prepare a 2-minute statement acting as one voice: Group A argues that fear of royalists caused the Terror; Group B argues that social and economic unrest (food shortages, riots) caused it; Group C argues that political struggles inside the Revolution caused it (power of the Committee of Public Safety). Use evidence from the facts we just read." Assign students quickly to groups and give them 3 minutes to prepare. Signal: "Group A speaks now" and time 2 minutes, then Group B 2 minutes, Group C 2 minutes. After all three, ask the class: "Which argument relied most directly on the arrest/execution numbers as evidence?"

Board: Write the three group names (A: royalists, B: social/economic, C: political power struggle) and a one-line prompt under each: 'One evidence sentence — use the Terror numbers or timeline.'

- Anticipate: Can we use outside facts? (Use only what we read today and what you remember from the previous lesson — keep it short.)
- Anticipate: What if we agree with more than one cause? (Say so — you can note multiple causes in your statement.)
- Anticipate: Do we have to perform? (Just read your 1–2 sentences clearly.)

27-34 min: Practise source analysis: short evidence task

Hand out a short printed excerpt with the Reign of Terror definition and the timeline example. Say: "Circle any phrase that shows the Terror was aimed at internal enemies. Underline any dates that show quick political change. You have 4 minutes." After 4 minutes, ask two students to read one underlined date and one circled phrase. Then say: "From this evidence, write one sentence answering: How did the Terror increase political instability?" Give students 3 minutes to write and collect answers.

Board: Project or tape the single-sentence definition of the Reign of Terror again (verbatim) and a reminder: 'Circle: internal enemies? Underline: fast changes?'

- Anticipate: Do we copy the whole excerpt? (No — just mark it and write one sentence.)
- Anticipate: What counts as 'internal enemies'? (Examples: alleged royalists, counter-revolutionaries, critics within the Revolution.)
- Anticipate: Is the timeline on the excerpt the same as what you wrote? (Yes — use those dates.)

34-38 min: Check understanding: quick whole-class share

Ask: "Who can read one student's sentence aloud that explains how the Terror increased instability?" Call on one volunteer to read. Then say: "Listen for cause and effect: did the Terror make people trust or fear the government more?" Ask for a thumbs-up (trust) or thumbs-down (fear). Tally quickly. Then summarize: "Most of you show that the Terror increased fear and political violence, which created instability that later helped the Thermidorian Reaction and the Directory to replace earlier institutions."

Board: Write the check question: 'Did the Terror increase trust or fear in government? (thumbs)' and note the class result: 'Mostly: fear -> instability.'

- Anticipate: Does fearing the government always lead to change? (Not always, but in this case it contributed to backlash and institutional change.)
- Anticipate: Is Thermidor the name of a person? (No—Thermidor is the month-name used for the reaction in July 1794.)

38-40 min: Consolidate and connect to the next lesson

Read aloud the final line on the board: the timeline from Estates General to Consulate. Say: "Tomorrow we'll study the fall and execution of Robespierre and the Law of 22 Prairial to see the immediate end of the Terror. For homework, write one paragraph using one fact from today that explains why the Directory was vulnerable to a coup in 1799." Collect any remaining work.

Board: Underline the timeline end: '18 Brumaire -> Consulate (Napoleon First Consul).' Write the homework

prompt: '1-paragraph: one fact from today + one sentence on why the Directory was vulnerable.'

- Anticipate: How long should the homework paragraph be? (One short paragraph — about 5–7 sentences.)
- Anticipate: Do we need more sources for homework? (Use facts from today and what we've learned previously.)

Blackboard Notes

- Lesson question
- Reign of Terror (definition)
- Quick timeline: Estates General -> Consulate
- Causes debated in class
- Check: did the Terror increase trust or fear?
- Homework
- Lesson question: How did the Terror create instability that led to the Directory and 18 Brumaire?
- Reign of Terror: A period (Sept 1793 – 3 July 1794) during which revolutionary authorities arrested about 300,000 people and executed some 16,600 on charges of counter-revolutionary activity.
- Thermidorian Reaction: end of the Terror in July 1794.
- Directory: replaced Committee of Public Safety in November 1795; lasted until 1799.
- 18 Brumaire (9 Nov 1799): coup -> Consulate; Napoleon becomes First Consul.
- Causes to consider: fear of royalists • social/economic unrest • political power struggles
- Class check: result = Mostly: fear -> instability
- Homework: One paragraph using one fact from today + one sentence why the Directory was vulnerable to a coup.
- Diagram: Horizontal timeline with marks: May 1789 (Estates General) — July 1789 (National Assembly & Bastille) — Aug 1789 (Abolition of feudalism/August Decrees) — Aug 1792 (fall of monarchy) — Sept 1793–3 July 1794 (Reign of Terror) — Nov 1795 (Directory) — 9 Nov 1799 / 18 Brumaire (Consulate)

Activities

Timeline Walk: Tracing the Terror to 18 Brumaire (12 min, field_task)

Materials: Printed timeline slips (one event per slip) — teacher prepares 10 slips listing short dated statements from 1793–1799 (see teacher list below), Tape or sticky tack, Stopwatch or classroom clock, Clipboard or notebook and pen for each student pair, Textbook or printed packet with the activity's three concept summaries (one per pair)

- Before class, cut up and prepare 10 timeline slips (examples below) and make one set per 4–5 pairs. Put pairs into groups of two students. Tell students they will place events in order on the classroom wall and add one sentence of evidence-based interpretation to explain

causal links.

- Start the activity with this prompt aloud: 'You have 12 minutes to place these events from the Reign of Terror through 18 Brumaire in chronological order on the wall and write one short evidence-based reason that links each adjacent event. Use the textbook packet for facts and statistics.' Give each pair one slip at a time from the set. Start the timer for 12 minutes.
- While students work, circulate. For each pair, check that they cite at least one piece of evidence from the packet (a number, date, or named institution) and ask one clarifying question: 'What evidence are you using to connect these two events?' If a pair is stuck after 3 minutes, offer the support sentence frame on the support sheet.
- With 2 minutes remaining, call 'Freeze.' Ask one volunteer pair to read one link aloud. Collect a quick whole-class exit note: each pair writes a one-sentence answer to 'Which single factor (social, economic, or political) do you think mattered most in moving from the Terror to the Directory? Give one piece of evidence.'

Student instructions:

- Work with your partner. You will get a stack of event slips. Read your textbook packet before placing slips.
- Place the slips on the wall in the order you think they happened from earliest (left) to latest (right). For each pair of neighbouring slips, write one short sentence on your clipboard that explains why those two events are linked. Use a specific fact or number from the packet (for example, 'about 16,600 executions') as evidence.
- If you disagree about order, each partner must state one piece of evidence for their view; then decide and write the evidence you used.
- When time is called, write one sentence answering: 'Which factor (social, economic, or political) mattered most in moving from the Reign of Terror to the Directory? Give one piece of evidence.'

Success looks like: Pairs have the slips arranged left-to-right showing a plausible chronological sequence (e.g., Reign of Terror items left of Thermidorian items, Directory items left of 18 Brumaire items); Each pair has written at least three link-sentences that each include a specific piece of evidence from the packet (a date, institution name, or statistic); Each pair completed the one-sentence exit answer citing a factor and a specific supporting fact.

Support: Pair students so one is stronger in reading. Provide this sentence frame to start link-sentences:

'Because [specific fact or date], this led to [next event] by increasing/decreasing [social/economic/political pressure].' Example worked first item: Slip A: 'Sept 1793–July 1794: Reign of Terror — ~300,000 arrests, ~16,600 executed.' Slip B: 'July 1794: Thermidorian Reaction ends the Terror.' Example link sentence: 'Because about 16,600 people were executed during the Terror, widespread fear and backlash grew and led to the Thermidorian Reaction.'

Extension: Choose one pair of adjacent events on the final wall and prepare a two-minute oral argument presenting a competing interpretation: explain one historian's view that emphasizes political causes and another that emphasizes social or economic causes. Cite at least two different pieces of evidence from the packet to support each interpretation.

Checkpoint Questions

- [remember] According to the definition in the text, what was the Reign of Terror and what two numbers does the source give to measure its scale?

Expected: The Reign of Terror was a period (Sept 1793–3 July 1794) during which revolutionary authorities arrested about 300,000 people and executed around 16,600 for counter-revolutionary activity.

- [understand] Give one way the Thermidorian Reaction changed government after July 1794 and name the government body that replaced the Committee of Public Safety by November 1795.

Expected: The Thermidorian Reaction ended the Terror and rolled back some revolutionary measures; by November 1795 the Directory replaced the Committee of Public Safety as the executive authority.

- [apply] Explain in one sentence how the instability of the Directory led to the Coup of 18 Brumaire and what political system followed.

Expected: The Directory was politically unstable and unpopular, which created conditions that allowed Napoleon's coup on 18 Brumaire (1799) to succeed; it established the Consulate with Napoleon as First Consul.

EXIT TICKET

Using evidence from the period summary, explain how social, economic and political factors combined to create a crisis that made calling the Estates General in 1789 necessary. Write a short paragraph and cite at least two specific pieces of evidence from the timeline or definitions in the text.

Success indicator: A correct response names at least one social factor, one economic factor, and one political factor; links each to a crisis (for example: social tensions between estates, economic strain/financial crisis, political deadlock of monarchy and parlements); and cites at least two pieces of evidence from the text/timeline (for example: reference to the calling of the Estates General in May 1789 and the sequence that follows).

Homework

- Create a one-page timeline (6–8 events) that traces from the calling of the Estates General (May 1789) to the Consulate (18 Brumaire/9 Nov 1799). Under each event, add one sentence saying why it contributed to political instability.
- Read the short in-class source used in the practise source analysis and write a 200-word paragraph answering: Did the Thermidorian Reaction restore stability or merely change who held power? Use two pieces of evidence from the period text.
- Write a concise answer (one paragraph, ~150 words) to the exit ticket prompt if you did not complete it in class: explain how social, economic and political factors combined to produce the crisis leading to the Estates General, with at least two textual citations.

Estimated time: 45 min

MENTOR MOMENT — WHEN A SINGLE DRAMATIC EVENT HIDES DEEPER CAUSES

A teacher once asked students why the Bastille mattered; one pupil named just the date, another traced how long-term social inequality, royal debt, and political paralysis made that day possible.

Takeaway: Look for the long-term social, economic and political pressures behind big events—dates matter, but causes explain why they happened.

Period 6

ENTRY TICKET

Write one sentence answering: Who was responsible for ending the Reign of Terror — the Convention that arrested Robespierre, ordinary Parisians, the army, or Robespierre's political mistakes? Pick the single best answer and give one short reason.

Expected response: A single choice (Convention / Parisians / army / Robespierre's mistakes) plus one sentence explaining the choice. For example: "The Convention — members denounced and arrested Robespierre because his power and the Law of 22 Prairial alarmed other deputies."

Teacher Script

0-6 min: Collect entry tickets and set goal

Ask students to put pens down. Say: "I'll collect your one-sentence entry tickets — hand them up quickly." As you collect, read aloud two contrasting answers (one blaming the Convention, one blaming Robespierre's mistakes). Then say: "Today's goal: by the end of class you should be able to explain why Robespierre fell and how that fall changed French government." Point to the board heading you will write. "We will look at three pieces of evidence from this period and then try a short role-play to test who benefits from the Thermidorian changes."

Board: Write the lesson goal heading and a one-line objective.

- Anticipate: Can I change my entry ticket after I hand it in? (No — we'll use these to start.)
- Anticipate: Do we need full sentences? (Yes, but brief — pick one reason.)
- Anticipate: Will you return the tickets? (No — I'll keep them to note common ideas.)

6-16 min: Explain fall of Robespierre and Law of 22 Prairial

Say: "I will read three short facts. Listen and follow on the board." Read clearly: 1) "10 June 1794: Law of 22 Prairial — it removed the right of many accused to defend themselves, which increased executions in Paris." Pause and ask: "Why would removing a right to defend increase executions?" Wait for answers; accept a range. 2) "July 1794: Members of the Convention denounced Robespierre; he attempted suicide, was arrested, and executed on 28 July with several allies." Ask: "What does an arrest by the Convention tell us about who had power?" 3) "After his fall: the Law of 22 Prairial was repealed and the Jacobin Club closed." Ask: "What immediate legal or political changes do those repeals create?" If a student mentions revenge killings in the south, say: "Yes — we'll touch on regional violence next."

Board: Write three numbered facts exactly: 1) Law of 22 Prairial (10 June 1794) — denied many accused the right to defend themselves; executions rose. 2) Arrest and execution of Robespierre — attempted suicide, arrested, executed 28 July 1794. 3) Aftermath — repeal of Law of 22 Prairial; Jacobin Club closed.

- Anticipate: Was Robespierre the only leader executed? (No — several colleagues were executed with him.)
- Anticipate: Did the army arrest him? (No — he was denounced and arrested by deputies in the Convention.)
- Anticipate: Why would deputies turn on him? (They feared his power and the consequences of the law; some historians say they acted to save themselves.)
- Anticipate: Did executions stop immediately after his fall? (Not everywhere — there were revenge killings in parts of France.)

16-28 min: Structured role-play: Thermidorian Convention deputies

Explain roles quickly: split class into three groups (Convention deputies, Jacobin supporters, worried moderates). Give each group 3 minutes to prepare one short line they would say on the convention floor (I will time you). Prompt each group: Convention deputies: explain why you vote to arrest Robespierre; Jacobin supporters: defend him; Worried moderates: explain how the Law of 22 Prairial made you afraid. After 3 minutes, invite one speaker from each group to deliver one line each (no more than 20 seconds). After the three lines, ask the class: "Which arguments helped the Convention majority justify arrest?" Write quick notes from their answers. If time remains, ask: "What consequences might the repeal of the law and closing of Jacobins have for local government and elections?"

Board: Create three column headings: Convention deputies | Jacobin supporters | Worried moderates. Under each, write one student quote from the role-play and one bullet consequence noted by class.

- Anticipate: What if I disagree with my role? (Stick to the role for the activity — we are testing arguments.)
- Anticipate: Can we use examples from the provinces? (Yes — mention revenge killings if you know them.)
- Anticipate: How long do we speak? (One line — 20 seconds max.)

28-34 min: Check understanding: quick written prompt

Hand out a 3-sentence exit check (or project it). Read it aloud: 1) Write one sentence: What was the Law of 22 Prairial and one consequence? 2) Write one sentence: Why did the Convention arrest Robespierre? 3) Circle whether the repeal of the law made France more or less likely to use state terror (circle: more / less / unsure) and give one reason. Give students 5 minutes to write. Collect answers.

Board: Project the three check sentences so every student can copy them.

- Anticipate: Do we need to write full sentences? (Yes, brief and clear.)
- Anticipate: What counts as a consequence? (Examples: more trials, more executions, fear in deputies, repeal later.)
- Anticipate: Can we say 'unsure'? (Yes, but give a short reason.)

34-40 min: Consolidate and link to Constitution of Year III

Say: "We've seen immediate legal changes after Thermidor — repeal of the Law of 22 Prairial and closing of the Jacobin Club. Now the Convention voted a new constitution in 1795. I will read two core facts and write them on the board." Read and point: "The Constitution of Year III created a bicameral legislature: Council of 500 and Council of Ancients, and a five-member executive called the Directory. Deputies were chosen by indirect election with property qualifications." Ask: "How might these changes reflect a reaction against the Terror?" Prompt answers: fewer concentrated powers, property rules to exclude the poorest, and indirect elections to reduce sudden popular pressure. End: "Next lesson we will use this to track how the Directory faced military and economic issues."

Board: Write: Constitution of Year III — Council of 500; Council of Ancients; Five-member Directory; deputies by indirect election; property qualifications.

- Anticipate: What does 'indirect election' mean? (Voters chose electors who then chose deputies.)
- Anticipate: Why property qualifications? (The Convention wanted to limit who could hold power; it was a reaction to popular democracy associated with the Terror.)
- Anticipate: Did the Directory stop violence? (It reduced some legal instruments of terror but

violence and unrest continued in places.)

Blackboard Notes

- Learning goal: Explain why Robespierre fell and what changed after Thermidor
- Key facts: Robespierre, Prairial, Aftermath
- Constitution of Year III — basic institutions
- Law of 22 Prairial — 10 June 1794: removed many accused people's right to defend themselves -> executions rose in Paris
- Robespierre: denounced in the Convention, attempted suicide, arrested, executed 28 July 1794 with allies
- After Thermidor: repeal of the Law of 22 Prairial; Jacobin Club closed; some revenge killings in south; some former Terror actors stayed in power
- Constitution of Year III (1795): bicameral legislature — Council of 500 and Council of Ancients
- Executive: five-member Directory; deputies chosen by indirect election; property qualifications for office
- Diagram: Three-column quick table for role-play: Convention deputies | Jacobin supporters | Worried moderates — fill with one quote under each
- Diagram: Simple flow: Law of 22 Prairial (June 1794) -> increase in executions -> Convention fear -> Arrest of Robespierre (28 July 1794) -> Repeal of Prairial / closing of Jacobins -> Constitution of Year III (1795)

Activities

Thermidor Debate: Who Caused the End of the Terror? (12 min, debate)

Materials: Printed short evidence slips (one per group) — 4 slips total, each with a short quote or fact (see teacher instructions for content), Stopwatch or visible timer, Whiteboard or chart paper and marker, Seats arranged for two debating sides

1. Before class (2 minutes): Prepare four short evidence slips on plain paper: A) description of Robespierre's arrest, suicide attempt and execution on 28 July; B) text summary of the Law of 22 Prairial (10 June) and its denial of defence leading to more executions; C) notes on Thermidorian revenge actions, closing of Jacobin Club and repeal of Prairial; D) summary of the Constitution of Year III and Directory institutions. Place one slip at each of four group stations.
2. Grouping and roles (1 minute): Divide the class into two debate teams (affirmative and negative), each with 4–6 students. Within each team assign: two speakers, one evidence reader, one note-taker, and remaining students as rebuttal/supporters.
3. Launch (1 minute): Tell students: "You will debate the motion: 'The fall of Robespierre was the primary cause of the end of the Terror.' The affirmative argues yes; the negative argues no (emphasizing laws, institutions, or other factors). Each team will pick one evidence slip from the four stations (teams may choose different slips). Start the 12-minute timer now."
4. While students work (12 minutes): Monitor time with the visible timer. At 8 minutes announce: "Two minutes to prepare final rebuttal." Circulate, read each team's notes, and quietly prompt students who are stuck by asking: "Which concrete fact from your slip supports your claim?" Do not offer answers, only questions to push evidence linking.

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5. Closing (1 minute after debate): Have each team's note-taker read one sentence that states the team's strongest evidence-based reason. Collect note-taker sheets or photos of the chart paper for assessment.

Student instructions:

- You are debating the motion: "The fall of Robespierre was the primary cause of the end of the Terror."
- Step 1 — Choose your stance: Your teacher has assigned your team as either affirmative (Agree) or negative (Disagree).
- Step 2 — Pick an evidence slip: One team member goes to a station and chooses one of the four evidence slips. Read it aloud to your team and decide how it supports your side.
- Step 3 — Prepare your case (6 minutes): Use the slip and your knowledge to make two linked points: a claim (your reason) and one piece of evidence from the slip or from class facts (for example: Robespierre's execution on 28 July; the Law of 22 Prairial denied defence; repeal of Prairial; Constitution of Year III created the Directory). The evidence reader reads the slip in the debate.
- Step 4 — Debate format and timing: Each speaker gets 60 seconds to speak. Affirmative speaker 1 opens, negative speaker 1 responds, affirmative speaker 2 rebuts, negative speaker 2 rebuts, then 60 seconds for each team's final summary. Use your remaining team members to hold up one short evidence phrase on a card when it's referenced (e.g., "Prairial denied defence").
- Step 5 — Focus on evidence and competing interpretations: During your remarks cite the slip or a fact and explain whether it shows causation (Robespierre's fall led directly to change) or shows other causes (laws, institutions, ongoing violence).

Success looks like: Each team cites at least one explicit fact from a slip aloud (e.g., 'Robespierre executed on 28 July' or 'Law of 22 Prairial denied defence').; Each team speaker responds to an opponent's point with a specific counter-evidence or interpretation (e.g., points to repeal of Prairial or to Constitution of Year III).; Note-takers produce one clear concluding sentence on chart paper that links a cause to a consequence (for example: 'Robespierre's execution allowed the Convention to repeal Prairial and close the Jacobin Club').

Support: If you cannot start, use this sentence frame and the worked example. Sentence frame: 'I claim that _____ because the evidence shows _____ (date or law). For example, Robespierre's execution on 28 July caused the Convention to act because they feared his power and then repealed the Law of 22 Prairial.' Worked first item: take the slip about Robespierre's arrest and read: 'Robespierre was arrested after a denunciation, attempted suicide, and executed on 28 July. This shows the Convention turned against him, which helps explain why they then repealed the Law of 22 Prairial.' Pair a lower-starting student with a stronger speaker as evidence reader.

Extension: Ask: 'Compare the end of the Terror to the establishment of the Directory: which change was deeper — the end of the Terror (immediate political purges) or the new Constitution of Year III (longer-term institutional change)? Use at least two pieces of evidence: one about Thermidorian actions and one about the Constitution's property-based indirect elections. Be prepared to explain which change mattered more for ordinary citizens' daily lives.'

Checkpoint Questions

- [understand] Quickly name two immediate legal or political changes that followed Robespierre's arrest and execution in July 1794.

Expected: The Law of 22 Prairial was repealed and the Jacobin Club was closed; also leaders of the Paris

Commune were arrested or executed and many Terror laws were rolled back.

- [analyze] Explain in one sentence how the Law of 22 Prairial changed trial rights and why that increased executions.

Expected: The law denied accused 'enemies of the people' normal rights to defense and limited evidence, which sped trials and made it easier for prosecutors to win convictions, producing a sharp rise in executions.

- [understand] State one institutional change the Constitution of Year III created to prevent concentration of power.

Expected: It set up a bicameral legislature (Council of 500 and Council of Ancients) and a five-member executive (the Directory) chosen by indirect election with property qualifications, making government broader and less centralized.

EXIT TICKET

In a short paragraph (about 6–8 sentences) analyze the causes and consequences of the Reign of Terror between 1793–1794 and explain why the Thermidorian Reaction followed. Use at least two specific pieces of evidence from this period.

Success indicator: The response explains at least one cause of the Terror (e.g., political crisis, war, fear of internal enemies), cites the Law of 22 Prairial or increased executions as evidence of how the Terror operated, and connects Robespierre's arrest/execution plus the repeal of the Law of 22 Prairial to the Thermidorian Reaction; it then gives at least one consequence (e.g., roll-back of Terror measures, reprisals in the south, or creation of the Year III constitution/Directory) and links these consequences to efforts to limit concentrated power.

Homework

- Write a one-page (250–350 words) short essay that argues why the Law of 22 Prairial was a turning point in the Reign of Terror. Use two specific examples from class notes or the period summary to support your point.
- Create a two-column chart (can be handwritten) listing three causes of the Reign of Terror on the left and three short-term consequences on the right, with one sentence explaining each link.

Estimated time: 40 min

MENTOR MOMENT — WHEN A SYSTEM PUSHES QUICK JUSTICE, MISTAKES GROW

A young clerk once told me he admired fast courts because they 'saved time.' When asked about one wrongful conviction later overturned, he admitted speed had hidden poor evidence and silenced witnesses.

Takeaway: Speed in trials can remove protections that prevent mistakes; reforms after the Terror show why legal rights matter even in crises.

Period 7

ENTRY TICKET

True or false? France permanently ended slavery across all its colonies on 4 February 1794. Briefly explain your answer in one sentence.

Expected response: False. The Convention voted to abolish slavery on 4 Feb 1794 and granted rights, but some emancipations began earlier in Saint-Domingue and implementation across colonies was uneven and contested.

Teacher Script

0-6 min: Collect entry tickets and set learning purpose

Read one or two student answers aloud (pick one that says True and one that says False). Say: "We asked about abolition on 4 February 1794. The Convention did vote to abolish slavery then and to give full rights in theory. But what actually happened in the colonies was more complicated. Today we will look at three connected areas: the wars and mobilisation, how the Directory governed at home, and what happened to slavery in the colonies. By the end I want you to be able to explain why the Terror ended and why Thermidor followed, using evidence."

Board: Write the lesson purpose (short). Copy one short student sentence from each example (True/False).

- Anticipate: If the Convention voted it, why wouldn't it be permanent?
- Anticipate: Was Saint-Domingue the same as other colonies?
- Anticipate: Will we cover Robespierre again?

6-13 min: Introduce the French Revolutionary Wars and mobilisation

Say: "Quick reminder: from 1792 the Revolution moved to total war. Use the whiteboard map I will draw. Ask: What does conscription or mobilisation mean for a country?" Wait for answers, then draw. Say: "Examples: major battles like Valmy and Jemappes showed revolutionary armies could win. By 1795 France had annexed neighbouring territories such as the Austrian Netherlands and created sister republics like the Batavian Republic." Ask: "How might large-scale mobilisation change politics at home?" Prompt answers that link army power to politics.

Board: Draw a simple map of north-eastern France, label Valmy, Jemappes; note dates 1792. Write short bullets about conscription, territorial annexations (Austrian Netherlands, Batavian Republic by 1795).

- Anticipate: Did conscription apply to everyone or just volunteers?
- Anticipate: Were Valmy and Jemappes both French victories?
- Anticipate: How did annexation work — did local people agree?

13-25 min: Explain Directory problems and evidence of army influence

Say: "The Directory began after the Constitution of Year III in 1795. It faced unrest and economic weakness. I will list specific problems and we will add evidence from sources." Write on the board: unrest, economic weakness, corruption, reliance on army. Read aloud one short quote from a Directory-era newspaper (teacher reads a supplied short line: 'The city is restless; troops keep order.'). Then ask: "How does that quote show reliance on the army?" Call on 2 students. Then say: "The Directory used military interventions to solve political deadlocks; this pattern of using the army helped lead to later coups, including 18 Brumaire." Ask: "What are the dangers when a government often uses the military to settle politics?"

Board: Write bullets: Unrest; Economic weakness; Corruption; Use of army to resolve deadlock; Leads toward

coups (18 Brumaire).

- Anticipate: Was corruption everywhere or only in the Directory?
- Anticipate: What exactly was 18 Brumaire?
- Anticipate: Did people support using the army to restore order?

25-30 min: Group discussion and source comparison: abolition in practice

Arrange students in groups of three. Give each group a short prompt to compare two pieces of evidence I read: (A) the Convention's vote on 4 Feb 1794 that abolished slavery and granted rights; (B) a report that commissioners in Saint-Domingue had begun emancipations before 1794. Task: In three minutes list one similarity and one difference about how emancipation reached people. Circulate and listen. After 3 minutes, ask two groups to share their similarity and difference. Emphasize: "These two pieces show competing perspectives: legal decree in Paris vs earlier actions in the colonies."

Board: Write the group task prompt and label the two sources: (A) Convention vote 4 Feb 1794; (B)

Commissioners in Saint-Domingue emancipating earlier.

- Anticipate: Does earlier emancipation in Saint-Domingue mean the colony was free before 1794?
- Anticipate: Which source is more reliable — Paris or the commissioners?
- Anticipate: Did all colonies react the same way?

30-35 min: Whole-class role-play debate and consolidation

Tell class: "We will do a quick role-play. I will name three roles: a Directory minister, a colonist planter, and a freed person in Saint-Domingue. I will call three volunteers. Each gets 30 seconds to say what they want from the government. After that, we will decide: did the Directory mostly use laws, money, or the army to solve problems?" Run the three short speeches, then lead the vote and ask students for evidence from today's notes. Finish: "Summarise in one sentence why the Thermidorian Reaction followed the Terror: say it aloud."

Board: Write the three roles and the final summary sentence starters: "Because...", "Therefore..."

- Anticipate: Can we choose other roles like a newspaper editor?
- Anticipate: What if none of the options (laws, money, army) fit?
- Anticipate: Do we have to use facts from the lesson only?

35-40 min: Check understanding and close

Ask three quick exit questions to the whole class and have students write one-line answers on a slip: 1) Name two effects of mobilisation on France. 2) Give one piece of evidence the Directory relied on the army. 3) What complication did abolition face after 4 Feb 1794? Collect slips. Read one or two aloud and correct misconceptions: emphasise that abolition was a legal step but uneven in practice, and that army power solved political problems but created dependence that ended in a coup.

Board: Write the three exit questions for students to copy.

- Anticipate: Will these be on the test?
- Anticipate: Can I change my slip after turning it in?
- Anticipate: Where can I read more about Saint-Domingue?

Blackboard Notes

- Today: Wars, Directory, and Colonial Emancipation
- French Revolutionary Wars (from 1792)
- Problems of the Directory
- Abolition in the colonies (4 Feb 1794)
- Mobilisation (conscription) from 1792 -> large citizen armies
- Major battles: Valmy, Jemappes (showed French army strength)
- Territorial changes by 1795: annexed Austrian Netherlands; Batavian Republic established
- Directory (after Constitution of Year III): unrest, economic weakness, corruption
- Directory often used the army to resolve political deadlocks -> pattern leading to coups (e.g. 18 Brumaire)
- 4 Feb 1794: Convention voted to abolish slavery and grant full rights in colonies
- Commissioners in Saint-Domingue began emancipations before 1794 — implementation across colonies was uneven
- Newspapers and pamphlets: key to debate — 130+ in 1789; 2,000+ in the 1790s
- Diagram: Simple map: north-eastern France with Valmy and Jemappes labelled; arrow to Austrian Netherlands and Batavian Republic
- Diagram: Three-column quick chart: Law in Paris | Actions in colonies | Effect (example: 4 Feb 1794 | Saint-Domingue commissioners | uneven implementation)

Activities

Four-Source Round: Causes and Consequences of the Terror (14 min, group_discussion)

Materials: One printed evidence slip per group (4 short primary/secondary excerpts; teacher can cut and hand out), A timer or stopwatch (phone is fine), One sheet of scrap paper or a sticky note per group, Whiteboard or chart paper and marker

1. Before class (or in the first minute): divide students into groups of 3. Hand each group a single printed evidence slip. Say: "You have 14 minutes to read your slip, discuss how it helps explain either (A) a cause of the Reign of Terror, (B) a consequence of it, or (C) why Thermidor followed, and be ready to share one claim and one piece of evidence." Start the timer for 14 minutes.
2. While groups work (minutes 0–9): circulate. For each group check they have read the slip aloud once, and ask one probing question: "Which specific action, event, or social pressure in this excerpt points to a cause or consequence?" Do not lecture; listen for students using the text to support claims.
3. Midway (at 7 minutes): announce a 60-second mini-rotate. Each group passes their slip to the next group and reads the new slip quickly, then adds one new note on their sticky note connecting the new slip to either the Terror or Thermidor. Restart the timer for the remaining 7 minutes.
4. Final minute: call time. Ask each group to pin or place their sticky note on the board under one of three headings you write on the board beforehand: Causes | Consequences | Reasons for Thermidor.
5. Wrap-up (final 2 minutes of the 14): pick three groups (a group that received different slips) to read their sticky note aloud. After each read, briefly (30 seconds) state aloud two competing interpretations you heard while circulating (for example: was the Terror a

necessary defensive measure, or primarily a result of political factionalism?). End by giving a one-sentence class summary linking violence, mobilisation, and political reaction.

Student instructions:

- 1. In your group of 3, read the printed slip aloud once together. The slip is a short primary or secondary excerpt connected to 1793–94.
- 2. Decide as a group whether the excerpt best shows: a cause of the Reign of Terror, a direct consequence of it, or evidence explaining why Thermidor (the backlash) happened. Mark your choice on your sticky note.
- 3. Write one clear claim (short sentence) on the sticky note that uses the excerpt as evidence. Under the claim, copy one phrase or sentence from the slip as your citation.
- 4. At the 7-minute signal, pass your slip to the next group, read that new slip quickly, and add one sentence on your sticky note that links the new slip to your original claim or to a different heading (cause / consequence / Thermidor).
- 5. At the end, place your sticky note under Causes, Consequences, or Reasons for Thermidor on the board. Be ready to read your one-sentence claim aloud if called on.

Success looks like: Each group has placed a sticky note labeled Cause, Consequence, or Reason for Thermidor on the board.; While circulating, teacher hears at least one student in each group read a direct phrase or sentence from their slip to support their claim.; At least two groups offer different interpretations aloud (for example: one frames the Terror as defensive mobilisation, another as factional power struggle) when the teacher restates competing interpretations.

Support: If you are unsure how to start, use this sentence frame: “This excerpt suggests that [short cause or event] contributed to the Terror because it shows [brief evidence].” Example (worked): “This excerpt suggests that mass mobilisation increased fear because it describes conscription and large armies moving across borders.” Pair a weaker reader with a stronger reader and ask the stronger reader to read aloud first.

Extension: For early finishers: write a 3–4 sentence paragraph on your scrap paper that compares the evidence you read about the Terror with one fact about the Directory (from class notes). Does the evidence suggest the Directory continued the same problems (military reliance, corruption) or reacted against them? Use at least one phrase from your slip as a citation and name one opposing interpretation.

Checkpoint Questions

- [apply] Why did France introduce mass conscription during the Revolutionary Wars, and how did that affect France’s position by 1795?

Expected: Conscription mobilised large numbers of soldiers quickly to defend the Revolution and fight abroad. It let France field bigger armies, win battles like Valmy and Jemappes, and by 1795 annex territories such as the Austrian Netherlands and set up allied republics (e.g., the Batavian Republic).

- [analyze] Give one clear example of how the Directory used the army in politics, and explain what that shows about the Directory’s strengths or weaknesses.

Expected: Example: the Directory relied on military force to put down uprisings and resolve political deadlocks (it depended on generals and interventions). This shows a weakness: limited popular legitimacy and political instability; and a strength: the army kept the government in power until 18 Brumaire.

- [understand] What did the Convention’s 4 February 1794 vote change in the colonies, and why does the text say commissioners in Saint-Domingue mattered earlier?

Expected: The Convention abolished slavery in the colonies and granted full rights regardless of colour. Commissioners in Saint-Domingue had already begun emancipating enslaved people before the national vote, so local actions pushed the national decision and show that emancipation was already happening on the

ground.

EXIT TICKET

Write a focused paragraph (5–8 sentences) that analyses two main causes of the Reign of Terror (1793–1794), two major consequences for French politics or society, and explains why the Thermidorian Reaction followed the Terror.

Success indicator: Paragraph names at least two causes (for example: foreign war and internal factional struggle or Committee policies), describes at least two consequences (for example: mass executions/political purges and political backlash leading to fear of radical rule), and explains the connection to Thermidor (for example: elite and political leaders reacted to excesses and legal changes, removing Robespierre and creating the Directory/Constitution of Year III).

Homework

- Make a one-page two-column chart titled 'Causes' and 'Consequences' of the Reign of Terror. Put at least three items under each column and add one sentence under each item explaining its importance (30 minutes).
- Choose one of the three Directory challenges discussed in class (political unrest, economic weakness, or corruption). Write a one-paragraph explanation of how the Directory tried to cope with it and whether using the army helped or hurt (20 minutes).
- Locate (teacher will supply) a short newspaper or pamphlet excerpt from the 1790s and annotate it with two questions about who wrote it and what audience it aimed for; bring the annotated excerpt to the next lesson (15 minutes).

Estimated time: 65 min

MENTOR MOMENT — WHEN A PAMPHLET CHANGED A DEBATE

A young clerk copied a popular pamphlet and handed it to soldiers leaving for the front; the pamphlet shaped how they talked about rights and the enemy when they returned home.

Takeaway: Prints and pamphlets reached ordinary people quickly; thinking about who wrote a source and who read it helps you judge its political effect.

Period 8

ENTRY TICKET

Quick: write one sentence answering both parts. 1) Name one symbol or song from the French Revolution you know. 2) Say in one short phrase what that symbol made people feel or do (for example: 'made them feel proud' or 'made them fear the government').

Expected response: Example: 'La Marseillaise — made people feel united and ready to fight.' A wrong or revealing answer might be 'guillotine — only cruelty' (this shows the misconception that it had only one meaning).

Teacher Script

0-4 min: Collect entry tickets and quick share

Ask students to hold up their sentence. Say: 'I will call three students with different answers.' Call one student who wrote a song (e.g. La Marseillaise), one who wrote a symbol (e.g. the guillotine), and one who wrote a short phrase showing fear or pride. Ask each: 'Why did you write that? One quick line.' After three answers, tell the class: 'We will use those answers to test a claim today: symbols and money changed how people saw the Revolution.'

Board: Write three student examples from the room as short phrases: e.g. 'La Marseillaise — united people', 'Guillotine — cruelty', 'Cockade — Paris identity'.

- Anticipate: Can I change my answer? (Yes, you can revise during the lesson.)
- Anticipate: Do I have to explain more than one sentence? (No, just one quick sentence now.)
- Anticipate: What if I wrote something wrong? (There are no wrong feelings here — we will test them.)

4-11 min: Introduce core definitions and contested meanings

Say: 'We will run through five definitions from the chapter. I will read each definition aloud. If you disagree, raise your hand.' Read each definition exactly as written on your sheet: La Marseillaise; Guillotine; Assignats; Liberty cap (Phrygian cap); Cockade (blue-and-red of Paris) and the role of women briefly. After each definition ask: 'Is this new or surprising?' Pause for 10 seconds. Then say: 'Notice the guillotine line says it was both celebrated by the left and cursed by the right. That shows symbols can have opposite meanings.'

Board: Under the earlier three examples, add five short definition headings (one line each) as you read them.

- Anticipate: Was La Marseillaise actually used by everyone? (It was adopted by the National Convention in 1795 and widely used as a revolutionary song — but not everyone agreed with it.)
- Anticipate: Who invented the guillotine? (We use the defined term 'an execution device invented during the Revolution' — details of the inventor are for later study.)
- Anticipate: Were cockades the same everywhere in France? (The blue-and-red cockade is linked to Paris, but local colors varied.)

11-18 min: Worked example: assignats -> inflation (guided)

Say: 'Now we will walk through the worked example from the chapter. I will draw a simple chain of events. Tell me if each step follows. Step 1: nationalise church and émigré lands. Step 2: issue

assignats backed by those lands. Step 3: issue too many assignats and poor harvests happen. Step 4: prices rise; people use black markets; assignats are withdrawn in 1796.' Draw each step and ask the class after each step: 'Does this follow? If not, why not?' Call on students who raised hands. Emphasize causal words: because, led to, and contributed. Ask: 'Which steps are causes and which are effects?'

Board: Draw a four-step arrow chain on the board with each step written: 1) Confiscation of lands -> 2) Issue assignats -> 3) Excess issuance + poor harvests -> 4) Inflation, price controls, black markets, withdrawal (1796).

- Anticipate: Did assignats have any value at first? (Yes; they were backed by confiscated lands, so they had value initially.)
- Anticipate: Why did poor harvests matter? (They reduced food supply, pushing prices up while more money chased less food.)
- Anticipate: Could the government have stopped inflation sooner? (The text says excessive issuance and other pressures produced hyperinflation; policy choices mattered.)

18-25 min: Prepare students for role-play positions

Say: 'You will role-play brief debates. Half the class argues that symbols (songs, caps, cockades, the guillotine) mostly shaped public opinion for the better (mobilized people, spread ideas). The other half argues that economic hardship from assignats and price controls mattered more for how people reacted. I will give each group two pieces of evidence to use from the chapter.' Hand out (or read aloud) two pieces of evidence per side: Symbols side: La Marseillaise adoption (1795) and use of cockade/liberty cap in public; Guillotine as a public spectacle. Economy side: Assignats chain of events, inflation and withdrawal in 1796, price controls and black markets. Ask groups to pick a spokesperson and prepare two short statements (one evidence sentence and one consequence sentence). Give one minute to discuss quietly in groups.

Board: Write the two debate positions as headings and list the two evidence bullets under each heading.

- Anticipate: Can a person use both symbol and economic evidence? (For this task, pick one side but you can mention the other briefly if you want to be persuasive.)
- Anticipate: What counts as evidence? (A fact from the chapter or the worked example is evidence.)
- Anticipate: How long should our statements be? (Two short sentences: one evidence, one consequence.)

25-36 min: Structured role-play/debate

Say: 'We will run a timed debate. Each side has 90 seconds to give their two statements. Then a 60-second rebuttal from the other side. After rebuttals, I will ask two quick questions to the class.' Use a visible timer. Call the symbols side first: the spokesperson gives evidence from the board and links it to public perception. Then the economy side responds with their evidence (assignats). Then each side gives a 60-second rebuttal. After both rebuttals ask the class: 'Which single piece of evidence changed your mind, if any?' Ask two students to explain briefly.

Board: During debate, tick off which evidence each side uses by marking a check next to the bullet they mention.

- Anticipate: Can we quote the guillotine both as symbol and as policy? (You can say it's a symbol; the policy use is part of why it became symbolic.)
- Anticipate: Do we have to stick to exactly the words from the chapter? (Use the chapter's facts — you can rephrase.)
- Anticipate: What if nobody in my group wants to speak? (Pick one person quietly or share the speaking; the spokesperson can read the group's prepared lines.)

36-40 min: Check for understanding and consolidate

Say: 'Final check: write one short line on a post-it or in your notes answering this: Name one piece of evidence that shows symbols shaped public opinion, and name one piece of evidence that shows economics shaped people's lives. Hand them to me or hold them up.' After collecting, read two examples aloud: one from each side. Close by summarizing: 'Symbols like La Marseillaise, cockades, and the liberty cap were powerful and had contested meanings; the guillotine was both symbol and spectacle. Assignats began as land-backed currency, but excessive issuance and poor harvests produced inflation and hardship.'

Board: Under the debate headings, add one final summary sentence: 'Symbols: contested meanings. Assignats: caused inflation and hardship.'

- Anticipate: Will we study the guillotine or assignats more later? (Yes — both are next units.)
- Anticipate: Do these summaries mean one side is right? (No — the text shows both mattered; our job is to weigh evidence.)
- Anticipate: What should I review tonight? (Read the definitions and the assignats worked example.)

Blackboard Notes

- Student examples from entry ticket
- Key definitions (read aloud)
- Worked example: Assignats -> Inflation
- Debate: Symbols vs Economics
- Final summary
- Student examples: La Marseillaise — united people; Guillotine — cruelty; Cockade — Paris identity
- La Marseillaise: A song composed in 1792 by Claude Joseph Rouget de Lisle, adopted by the National Convention as the First Republic's anthem in 1795.
- Guillotine: An execution device invented during the Revolution, celebrated by the left as the people's avenger and cursed by the right as the symbol of the Terror; it became a public spectacle.
- Assignats: Paper currency backed by nationalised church and émigré lands used during the Revolution; excessive issuance contributed to hyperinflation.
- Liberty cap (Phrygian cap): A brimless, felt conical cap with the tip pulled forward, symbolising Roman republicanism and liberty.
- Role and repression of women: Women participated in activism and societies early, but 1791 and 1793 constitutions denied political rights; October 1793 banned women's clubs.
- Worked example chain: 1) Confiscation of church & émigré lands -> 2) Issue assignats backed by lands -> 3) Excess issuance + poor harvests -> 4) Inflation, price controls, black markets -> withdrawal of assignats (1796).
- Debate evidence (Symbols): La Marseillaise adoption (1795); cockade & liberty cap; guillotine as public spectacle and symbol.
- Debate evidence (Economics): Assignats issued against confiscated lands; excessive issuance caused hyperinflation; price controls and black markets followed.
- Final summary: Symbols had contested meanings (could unite or terrify). Assignats produced real economic hardship when over-issued.
- Diagram: Three-column list from entry ticket: Song | Symbol | Feeling (fill with student

examples).

- Diagram: Four-step arrow chain for assignats example: Confiscation -> Issue assignats -> Excess issuance + poor harvests -> Inflation & consequences.
- Diagram: Two-column debate table with checks beside used evidence during debate.

Activities

Symbols and Voices: A 12-Minute Role Play on Revolutionary Symbols and Economics (12 min, role_play)

Materials: Printed role slips (one per student) — teacher prepares in 5–10 minutes, One copy of the chapter or textbook passage for each group (or projected key excerpts), Timer or stopwatch (phone or classroom clock), One sheet of chart paper and a marker per group

- 1. Arrange students in groups of four. Give each student a role slip (see roles below) and give each group a copy of the chapter excerpts or project the same excerpts for all to see. Explain: 'You will do a 7-minute role play and a 5-minute reporting/reflection.' Start the timer at the beginning of the role-play phase.
- 2. Read aloud to the whole class: "Use evidence from the chapter to make your character speak about at least two symbolic or economic issues from the Revolution (La Marseillaise, cockade/tricolore/liberty cap, guillotine, women's political role, or assignats/price controls). Present competing perspectives—why different people saw the same symbol differently." Then instruct groups to plan for 2 minutes and perform for 5 minutes.
- 3. While groups plan and perform, circulate quickly: listen for specific chapter evidence (dates, quotes, or facts) and remind groups to state the evidence aloud in the play if they forget (e.g., 'Rouget de Lisle wrote La Marseillaise in 1792'). Note one example from 2–3 groups to share later.
- 4. After performances, give each group 3 minutes to write on chart paper: (a) two ways newspapers or symbols influenced public perception (each must cite chapter evidence), and (b) one example of a competing interpretation they used. Then call two groups to present their chart paper (1 minute each).
- 5. Conclude with a 1-minute whole-class prompt: ask students to vote by show of hands whether a given symbol (teacher names one) was mainly unifying or mainly divisive, and ask one student to state the chapter evidence behind the vote.

Student instructions:

- You are in a group of four. Each of you has a role: Revolutionary Supporter, Moderate Citizen, Woman Activist, and Newspaper Editor (role slips name one).
- Step 1 (2 minutes): Read your role slip and the small excerpt of the chapter your group has. Decide who will speak first. Plan a 5-minute role play in which each person speaks as their character and uses at least one piece of evidence from the chapter (a date, a short quote, or a fact). Your play must include at least two of these topics: La Marseillaise, a revolutionary symbol (cockade/tricolore/liberty cap), the guillotine, women's political role, or assignats/price controls.
- Step 2 (5 minutes): Perform your role play for the class. In the performance, each character must: state one piece of chapter evidence aloud, offer a perspective on a symbol or economic issue, and respond to another character with a competing interpretation.
- Step 3 (3 minutes): After the performance, work together to write on chart paper: (a) two ways newspapers or symbols influenced public perception during the Revolution, each with

the chapter evidence you used, and (b) one competing interpretation you presented in the play.

- Be ready to present your group's chart paper in 1 minute.

Success looks like: Each group performs a role play in which all four students speak and at least two different Revolution topics from the chapter are mentioned aloud.; During performances, students state specific chapter evidence (a date, short quote, or named fact) at least twice per group.; Each group's chart paper lists two concrete ways newspapers or symbols influenced public perception and cites the chapter evidence used in the play.

Support: Pair a stronger reader with a student who needs help and reduce roles to three (combine Moderate Citizen and Newspaper Editor). Use this sentence frame for each speech: "As [role], I believe ___ because the chapter says ___ (date or short quote)." Example first line for the Newspaper Editor: "As the Editor, I printed La Marseillaise in 1792 because Rouget de Lisle composed it that year and the chapter shows it became a revolutionary song."

Extension: Ask the group to add a 30-second epilogue in which a character predicts how the symbols or assignats will be remembered by future historians; require citation of one additional primary-type detail from the chapter (for example, the 1795 adoption of La Marseillaise or the 1796 withdrawal of assignats) and explain how historians might disagree about its importance.

Checkpoint Questions

- [apply] Name two revolutionary symbols from the period (choose from La Marseillaise, the cockade, the liberty cap, or the guillotine) and for each, give one sentence explaining how it shaped public opinion.

Expected: Example: La Marseillaise — adopted in 1795 and used as a revolutionary song, it rallied citizens and framed the Revolution as a patriotic cause. Cockade — the blue-and-red Paris cockade marked who belonged to the revolutionary political community and made support visible in streets and clubs.

- [analyze] How did people at the time view the guillotine differently? Give one piece of evidence from the period that shows a positive view and one that shows a negative view.

Expected: Positive view: the left celebrated the guillotine as 'the people's avenger' (shows it could be seen as justice). Negative view: the right cursed it as the symbol of the Terror (shows it was also seen as cruelty).

- [apply] Using the worked example from the text, briefly explain how assignats led to inflation. Include two linked causes from the chapter.

Expected: Confiscation of church and émigré lands backed assignats, but excessive issuance of assignats plus poor harvests increased the money supply and reduced confidence, producing hyperinflation, black markets, and price controls.

EXIT TICKET

Using two pieces of evidence from the chapter, describe two different ways newspapers or symbols influenced public perception during the Revolution. Be specific: name the newspaper or symbol and quote or paraphrase the evidence that shows its effect.

Success indicator: Response names two distinct newspapers or symbols (e.g. La Marseillaise, the cockade, a newspaper/pamphlet) and for each provides a specific piece of evidence from the chapter (adoption date or phrase like 'revolutionary song', 'blue-and-red of Paris', or mention of pamphlets/newspapers shaping opinion) and explains how that evidence shows influence on public perception.

Homework

- Reread the chapter sections on La Marseillaise, the guillotine, and assignats. Choose one symbol (not assignats) and write a short paragraph (4–6 sentences) that uses two pieces of evidence from the chapter to explain how that symbol shaped public opinion.
- Write a 3–4 sentence role card for either: (a) a woman whose political clubs were closed in 1793, explaining how the ban changed her life and political voice, or (b) a market trader in 1794 explaining how assignat inflation affected prices and customers. Use vocabulary from the period.
- Optional short task: create three quick flashcards (term on front, one-line definition from the chapter on back) for La Marseillaise, guillotine, and assignats.

Estimated time: 30 min

MENTOR MOMENT — WHEN A SONG CHANGED THE MOOD OF A ROOM

At a school play about the Revolution, the class sang La Marseillaise before a debate; suddenly students stopped arguing and paid attention, because the song made the stakes feel real.

Takeaway: Symbols like songs can change how people feel and make political arguments more persuasive—use them carefully when you argue a point.

Period 9

ENTRY TICKET

Quick choice (2 minutes): Which two statements are true about assignats and symbols during the Revolution? Circle two.

- A. Assignats were paper money created after the government seized church and émigré land.
- B. Assignats caused inflation only because foreign governments refused to accept them.
- C. Symbols like the cockade and La Marseillaise helped shape how people saw the Revolution.
- D. The guillotine was only a symbol and was never written about as an object of study.

Write the two letters you choose and one short reason (one sentence) for one of your choices.

Expected response: Correct choices: A and C. A is true: assignats were issued after confiscations. C is true: symbols influenced public perception. Common wrong choices: B is wrong because inflation had several causes including over-issuance and poor harvests, not just foreign acceptance. D is wrong because historians have written about the guillotine as a subject (see Opie).

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Collect entry tickets + quick share

Collect the papers quickly. Say aloud: “Two quick results I see — most picked A and C. A few picked B or D, which tells me we need to check what caused inflation and whether the guillotine was studied as an object, not just a symbol. Hold on to your ticket; we’ll return to it.” Walk to the board and underline the plan title you will write next.

Board: Write the period title and the five-step plan heading (short).

- Anticipate: Why are we keeping the tickets?
- Anticipate: Is my answer wrong if I picked B or D?
- Anticipate: Will we talk about all the symbols from the last lesson?

5-13 min: Introduce new material: long-term impacts & bibliography

Say: “Today we move from symbols and crisis to long-term effects and how historians study them. I will read three short claims from the chapter; after each claim, I’ll ask you to raise your hand if you think it’s supported by evidence in the chapter. Claim 1: ‘The Revolution ended feudalism in France.’ Raise your hand. Claim 2: ‘The Revolution promoted individual freedoms and influenced constitutions in other countries.’ Raise your hand. Claim 3: ‘Napoleonic legal codes were a main way the Revolution’s ideas spread across Europe.’ Raise your hand.” Pause after each and nod. Then say: “All three are supported, but historians disagree about how complete those changes were and how long they lasted. We also have a bibliography listing works on the guillotine and assignats — that means scholars have debated these topics in detail.” Show the example from the source: “Worked example — confiscation -> assignats -> over-issuance + poor harvests -> inflation.” Point to the board flow-chart you will draw next.

Board: Draw short headings: Long-term impacts; Bibliography note; Worked example (start the flow chart).

- Anticipate: What does 'ended feudalism' mean exactly?
- Anticipate: Did everyone in Europe get the Napoleonic codes?
- Anticipate: What is a bibliography used for?

13-25 min: Group debate / role play: historians' interpretations

Divide the class into three groups and assign roles: Group A = argue that the Revolution created lasting change; Group B = argue that change was limited and reversed later; Group C = historians' critics who point to specific evidence (e.g. rural continuities, inflation). Give 2 minutes to plan. Prompt: "Use one piece of evidence from the chapter or the bibliography example. For instance: point to the Napoleonic codes as evidence for lasting change, or point to inflation and social unrest as limits." After planning, run three 2-minute mini-debates: Group A speaks, Group B responds, Group C asks one critical question. If time allows, swap speakers. Circulate, listen, and when each group finishes, ask one quick follow-up: "Which source would you cite from the bibliography to back your point?"

Board: Write group roles and quick reminders: use one chapter fact + cite one bibliography item (example: Opie on guillotine; assignats literature).

- Anticipate: Can we use examples from the previous lesson (cockade, La Marseillaise)?
- Anticipate: What kind of evidence counts as 'from the chapter'?
- Anticipate: Do we have to cite a specific book or can we say 'a historian'?

25-33 min: Practice source analysis: assignats and guillotine examples

Hand out one short extract from the chapter (teacher supplies a 2-paragraph extract: first paragraph summarises assignats and confiscation; second paragraph mentions inflation and debates). Ask pairs: "Find one sentence that supports the worked example chain and one sentence that shows historians disagree." Give 4 minutes. Then call two pairs to read their sentences aloud. Next: show the guillotine bibliography note: say: "The bibliography lists Opie's Guillotine and other works. What does that tell you about how historians treat the guillotine?" Wait for answer: "It is both a symbol and an object of study; historians analyse its use, meaning, and political context."

Board: Write two prompts: 1) Quote one sentence that supports the assignats -> inflation chain. 2) Quote one sentence that shows disagreement. Add 'Guillotine = symbol + studied object' beneath.

- Anticipate: Where is the extract from exactly?
- Anticipate: How long should our quoted sentence be?
- Anticipate: Is Opie the only historian on the guillotine?

33-38 min: Check for understanding: apply evidence task

Ask everyone to write a very short answer (3–4 lines): "Name two ways newspapers or symbols (for example La Marseillaise or the cockade) influenced public perception during the Revolution. For each, give one piece of evidence from the chapter or bibliography." Give 3 minutes to write. Then ask two volunteers to read theirs. If a student gives a weak answer, prompt: "Which source supports that?" or "Can you name a detail from the chapter?"

Board: Write the question for students to copy: 'Apply evidence: 2 ways symbols/newspapers influenced public perception + 1 supporting piece of evidence each.'

- Anticipate: Do newspapers mean printed papers like pamphlets?
- Anticipate: Can I use La Marseillaise as both a symbol and a newspaper example?
- Anticipate: What counts as 'evidence' from the chapter?

38-40 min: Consolidate and tie back to entry ticket

Say: "Two quick takeaways: 1) The Revolution led to major legal and social changes that historians still debate about their reach and durability. 2) Assignats and the guillotine are not just facts; they are topics scholars study and argue about. Now look at your entry ticket: if you

picked B or D, check the margin — I'll write a short note showing why those are incomplete. Keep your tickets as your exit check." Circulate and mark a quick tick or short note on a few tickets.

Board: Under the earlier headings, add two final bullets: 'Takeaways' and short notes restating the two points.

- Anticipate: Will the marked tickets affect grades?
- Anticipate: Can we keep the notes for the exam?
- Anticipate: Will we read Opie in full later?

Blackboard Notes

- Period 9: Revolutionary Symbols, Sources, and Legacy
- Plan for today
- Long-term impacts (claims)
- Worked example: Assignats -> Inflation
- Bibliography notes
- Apply evidence: 2 ways symbols/newspapers influenced perception
- Takeaways
- Plan: Activate prior knowledge; New material; Debate; Source analysis; Check understanding; Consolidate
- Claims supported in chapter: Ended feudalism; Promoted individual freedoms; Napoleonic codes spread reforms
- Worked example chain:
 - • Confiscation of church + émigré lands -> government issues assignats
 - • Excessive issuance of assignats + poor harvests -> inflation
- Bibliography: includes works on Guillotine (Opie) and debates on assignats
- Guillotine: symbol of Terror AND object of historical study (monographs exist)
- Apply evidence task: Name 2 ways symbols/newspapers influenced perception + cite one piece of evidence each
- Takeaways: Changes were real but historians dispute their scope; Assignats & guillotine are debated topics, not just facts
- Diagram: Flow chart: Confiscation of land -> Issue assignats -> Increased supply of paper money -> Inflation (note: add 'plus poor harvests' as a contributing factor)
- Diagram: Three-column list for debate roles: Lasting change | Limited change | Critical evidence (list one example under each)

Activities

Gallery Walk: How Newspapers and Symbols Shaped Revolutionary Opinion (12 min, gallery_walk)

Materials: 4 sheets of chart paper (placed around the room), pre-written station slips (one per chart) summarizing a short excerpt or bibliographic note from the chapter — 4 slips total, sticky notes (several per student), pens or pencils, textbook or chapter printout for reference, timer or stopwatch

1. Arrange students in pairs as they enter. Place one chart paper and one station slip at each of four points around the room. Set the timer for 12 minutes total and explain the time at each station (3 minutes per station).
2. Start the activity by saying: "You will rotate through four stations. At each station read

the short excerpt or bibliographic note, then write one piece of evidence from the text and one interpretation about how newspapers or a symbol (like the cockade or La Marseillaise) influenced public perception. Note if sources or historians disagree.”

- 3. Signal pairs to begin at Station 1. After 3 minutes, ring the bell and have pairs rotate clockwise. Repeat until each pair has visited all four stations (12 minutes total). While students work, circulate quietly to check that they cite text evidence and note if interpretations conflict.
- 4. After the walk, spend 2–3 minutes collecting one verbal report from two pairs: ask each to read one sticky note they wrote that shows an evidence-based claim and one that presents a competing interpretation.

Student instructions:

- 1. Work with your partner. At each station you have 3 minutes.
- 2. Read the short excerpt or bibliographic note on the station slip and look in the textbook if you need more context.
- 3. On a sticky note, write two sentences: (a) one short phrase of evidence from the text (quote or page number) about newspapers or a symbol; (b) one sentence interpretation that explains how that source could have shaped public perception. If the station shows more than one historian’s view, say which view you accept and why.
- 4. Place your sticky note on the chart paper, then move to the next station when the teacher signals.

Success looks like: Most pairs leave a sticky note at each station that includes a direct piece of text evidence (a quoted phrase or a page/author citation).; Pairs’ interpretation sentences link the evidence to a specific effect on public perception (for example: increased support for revolutionary change, fear of counter-revolution, spread of nationalist feeling).; At least two pairs can orally state one place where historians or sources disagree about the influence of newspapers or symbols.

Support: Pair a struggling student with a confident partner. Provide this sentence frame to start: “The text says ‘_____’ (cite page). This suggests that newspapers/symbols made people feel _____ because _____.” Also give the partner one reduced task: only record evidence and one simple interpretation (omit comparing historians).

Extension: Choose one station and write a 4–6 sentence mini-argument on the back of the chart paper: use two different sources from the station area (e.g., a newspaper quote and a bibliographic note about assignats or the guillotine) to argue which had the stronger long-term impact on public perception in France — newspapers or symbols — and explain how that influence later affected another European country (cite a bibliography entry).

Checkpoint Questions

- [apply] Give one specific example from the chapter of how a symbol (La Marseillaise, the cockade, or the guillotine) changed how ordinary Parisians viewed the Revolution. Explain in one sentence how that symbol did the work you name.

Expected: Example: The guillotine made the Terror visible and public, so many Parisians saw executions as both a tool of justice and a sign of revolutionary power; this increased fear of opponents and made the Revolution seem irreversible. (Marks for naming a symbol and linking it to a public reaction: fear, unity, legitimacy, or normalisation of violence.)

- [apply] Using the chapter’s discussion of newspapers and songs, state one way printed reports or La Marseillaise influenced people’s actions or opinions, and give a short piece of evidence or a phrase from the chapter that supports it.

Expected: Newspapers and songs spread patriotic language that framed enemies as traitors and encouraged

mobilisation; evidence: chapter notes that popular press and 'La Marseillaise' helped turn local disputes into national causes and gave people words to call for resistance. (Marks for linking medium -> effect -> supporting phrase.)

- [apply] Explain briefly how a symbol could carry different meanings for different groups (for example, the cockade for a sans-culotte and for a royalist) using the chapter's idea about exported reforms or contested memory.

Expected: For a sans-culotte the cockade signalled popular citizenship and shared rights; for a royalist it was a sign of sedition and loss of traditional order. The chapter indicates symbols were contested and used to claim legitimacy, so meanings depended on political position. (Marks for showing contrast and tying to idea of contested legitimacy.)

EXIT TICKET

Write a short paragraph that applies evidence from the chapter to describe two distinct ways newspapers or revolutionary symbols influenced public perception during the Revolution. Use at least one concrete example from the chapter.

Success indicator: Paragraph names two distinct influence types (for example: shaping fear/legitimacy, mobilising action, normalising violence, or framing enemies), cites one concrete example from the chapter for at least one type (e.g., guillotine, La Marseillaise, cockade, or role of newspapers), and explains in one sentence how each example caused that change in perception.

Homework

- Choose one revolutionary symbol from the chapter (La Marseillaise, the cockade, the guillotine or assignats as a symbol of economic change). Find and copy two short quotes or bibliographic references from the chapter that show how people reacted to that symbol. Write a 150-word paragraph applying those pieces of evidence to explain how the symbol changed public perception.
- Prepare one question about how symbols were used differently in other European countries (tie to the chapter's claim that reforms exported across Europe). Bring the paragraph and the question to the next class.

Estimated time: 30 min

MENTOR MOMENT — WHEN A FLAG CHANGED A DEBATE

A teacher once brought two identical reports of a riot into class but printed one with a headline calling protesters 'patriots' and one calling them 'mob'. Students read the versions differently and argued with evidence from the headlines before reading the body.

Takeaway: Small words and symbols shape how people interpret events; always ask who chose that symbol or headline and why.

Learning Gaps & Misconceptions

[high] The French Revolution happened simply because the government ran out of money — once the state was bankrupt, people revolted and the Revolution followed directly.

- Diagnostic: Which of these statements best explains why the French monarchy called the Estates-General in 1788–1789?

Reveals: Whether the student attributes the convocation solely to fiscal collapse or recognises a mixture of fiscal, political and social pressures (including elite resistance to reform and demand for political change).

- Diagnostic: Which factor was the main cause of the popular unrest in 1789: rising bread prices, Enlightenment ideas, resistance by the nobility to reform, or the failing royal budget? Explain your choice in one sentence.

Reveals: Whether the student reduces the Revolution to a single, immediate cause (economic collapse) instead of recognising that unrest drew on several interacting causes and differing local triggers.

- Remediation: Source-comparison carousel (30 minutes): students rotate through 4 short primary-source stations (a minister's fiscal report, a peasant petition about rents, an urban artisan letter about bread prices, and a noble's memorandum rejecting reform). At each station they answer two prompts: 'What problem does this source highlight?' and 'Who benefits from/loses by the current system?'

Why: Confronts the student with simultaneous, distinct pieces of evidence that point to fiscal, social, economic and political causes. By asking about beneficiaries/losers, students must link structural interests to motivations, breaking the single-cause narrative and showing how different groups experienced crises differently.

- Remediation: Structured evidence-weighting task (20 minutes): give students a short list of causes (debt/fiscal crisis, social inequality of the estates, resistance of elite to reform, food shortages, political ideas) and a timeline of events 1786–1789. In pairs they place each cause on a 'short-term / long-term' continuum and write one piece of evidence from the sources/timeline that supports its placement.

Why: Forces students to distinguish immediate triggers from deep-seated causes and to justify their judgements with evidence. This addresses the tendency to conflate chronology with sole causation and trains students to treat 'cause' as multi-layered and contingent.

- Remediation: Mini-debate with competing interpretations (25 minutes): split the class into three groups representing different historians' arguments (economic/financial interpretation, socio-political/estate-conflict interpretation, and ideological/cultural interpretation). Each group prepares two evidence-based points and one concession (a piece of evidence that supports another view) and then presents to the class.

Why: Models the discipline's practice of weighing competing interpretations grounded in evidence, teaches students that historians disagree, and requires them to use primary evidence to defend a nuanced view rather than restating a simple, single-cause story.

[medium] The guillotine was only a symbol of cruelty and the Terror — people only associated it with mass executions and fear.

- Diagnostic: Look at a caricature from 1793 showing a crowded square around a guillotine with a banner praising popular justice. What does this source most likely tell us about how

at least some contemporaries viewed the guillotine?

Reveals: If the student answers that it only shows fear and cruelty, they are treating all evidence about the guillotine as evidence of a single negative meaning rather than recognising contested contemporary attitudes.

- Diagnostic: Which of these two contemporary texts would best support the claim that some revolutionaries celebrated the guillotine as a symbol of popular justice: (A) a ledger of executions listing names and dates, or (B) a revolutionary song praising the 'people's avenger' and the fall of aristocrats? Explain briefly.

Reveals: A student holding the misconception will favour the ledger or claim both only support cruelty, failing to recognise sources that express positive or celebratory meanings.

- Remediation: Show students two primary sources side by side: an execution register or eyewitness account emphasizing deaths and terror, and a left-wing pamphlet or popular song from the 1790s that praises the guillotine as 'the people's avenger.' Ask small groups to list what each source is doing (information, persuasion, celebration) and to annotate language or images that signal tone.

Why: Placing contrasting contemporaneous evidence together makes visible that the guillotine carried multiple meanings. Annotating persuasive language versus factual recording forces students to use evidence to infer attitudes rather than rely on present-day labels.

- Remediation: Run a short source-provenance activity: for the same celebratory pamphlet, have students identify the author/audience/purpose and then ask whether that provenance would make the pamphlet reliable for claiming general public opinion. Then repeat for a repression-focused source. Lead a class discussion on how social position and purpose shape portrayals.

Why: Teaching provenance shows why different groups produced different representations — political actors sometimes promoted the guillotine positively. This addresses the root error (overgeneralisation) by helping students weigh sources rather than assume a single cultural meaning.

- Remediation: Conclude with a short comparative writing task: give students two minutes to write a one-sentence claim about what the guillotine symbolised, then two pieces of evidence (one fear-based, one celebratory) supporting a qualified claim that acknowledges contestation.

Why: Forcing students to craft a nuanced claim with paired evidence moves them from a binary view to a contextualised interpretation grounded in texts, matching the lesson's emphasis on competing interpretations and causation.

[medium] The Storming of the Bastille on 14 July 1789 was the single decisive event that caused the French Revolution — once the Bastille was taken everything became revolutionary and the monarchy fell immediately.

- Diagnostic: How many prisoners were being held in the Bastille on 14 July 1789, and why does that number matter for understanding the event?

Reveals: Whether the student treats the storming as a large-scale liberation of many oppressed people (symbolic, decisive cause) rather than a politically symbolic attack on royal authority with limited immediate practical effect.

- Diagnostic: Did the National Assembly immediately replace the monarchy and pass all its radical reforms the day after the Bastille was stormed? Explain briefly.

Reveals: Whether the student assumes a single event produced instant, comprehensive political change instead of recognising a sequence of actions, negotiations and regional variations after 14 July.

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Remediation: Begin a 15-minute source comparison: give students three brief primary extracts (a Parisian eyewitness account emphasising fear and symbolism, the Bastille prison register listing seven prisoners, and a page from the June–August 1789 timeline of laws and protests). In pairs, students answer: which sources show symbolism, which show limited immediate effect, and which show ongoing political steps?

Why: Confronting a striking eyewitness narrative with documentary facts (prison register) and the legislative timeline forces students to separate dramatic symbolism from material effect and to see change as a sequence. This directly addresses the over-generalisation from dramatic images to causal certainty.

- Remediation: Run a 20-minute structured sequencing activity: provide cards describing events and conditions (food shortages, Estates-General, Storming of the Bastille, formation of the National Guard, abolition of feudal privileges, royal resistance). Students work in small groups to place cards into 'causes', 'symbolic events', and 'consequences', then justify one placement to the class with textual evidence.

Why: Making students categorize and justify shows that the Bastille is best understood as a symbolic trigger within a broader set of causes and consequences; requiring textual evidence prevents reliance on memory of a single dramatic date.

- Remediation: Conclude with a 10-minute comparative reflection: present two historians' short arguments (one emphasizing the Bastille as decisive symbol, another seeing it as one event among many structural causes). Ask students to write one paragraph weighing both interpretations and citing the primary evidence they've seen.

Why: Presenting competing interpretations models historical practice and asks students to weigh evidence rather than accept a single narrative; this addresses the tendency to accept a simple causal story from dramatic imagery.

[medium] The Third Estate just walked out of the Estates-General and immediately seized control by declaring themselves the National Assembly — it was a single dramatic break where the commoners decided to take power.

- Diagnostic: When the Estates-General met in May–June 1789, how were votes decided between the three Estates (clergy, nobility, Third Estate)?

Reveals: A student who answers incorrectly treats the Estates-General as if it already practised 'one deputy, one vote' and therefore believes the Third Estate had an immediate majority and so could legitimately 'leave' to form a government.

- Diagnostic: Which best describes how representatives of the Third Estate became the National Assembly in June 1789?

Reveals: A wrong answer shows the student thinks the change was instantaneous and unilateral rather than the result of mandates from local electors, shifting alliances, and repeated disputes over procedure.

- Remediation: Begin the lesson with paired primary-source reading: excerpts from (a) deputies' cahiers and instructions to Third Estate delegates, (b) the August 1788 royal summons and rules for the Estates-General, and (c) the June 17, 1789 proclamation of the National Assembly. Ask pairs to list what each source says about who can decide votes, who the deputies represent, and whether deputies were told to form a new body.

Why: Comparing the actual instructions and proclamations makes visible the legal ambiguity and local mandates that constrained deputies. This addresses the root: students' simplified narrative by forcing them to confront contemporary evidence that the move was negotiated and grounded in electoral mandates, not a single unilateral seizure.

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Remediation: Run a short classroom role-play of the Estates-General rules: assign groups as clergy, nobles, and Third Estate with realistic numbers of deputies and written 'mandates' (some instructing to insist on estate voting, others to demand head-count voting). Play two rounds—one with 'voting by order' and one with 'voting by head'—then simulate the debate over whether the Third Estate can meet separately and why some clergy/nobles join them.

Why: Experiencing how different voting procedures change outcomes and how mandates limit delegates helps students see why deputies negotiated and why some members of the other Estates joined the Third Estate. This corrects the false image of an immediate, uncontested takeover by showing the procedural and political complexity.

- Remediation: Show a short timeline activity: students place dated excerpts (royal summons, meetings, the stalemate over voting, the Tennis Court Oath, deputies of some clergy/nobles joining) on a timeline and write one sentence about causation between each event. Conclude with a class discussion presenting competing interpretations from historians (e.g., sudden coup vs. gradual constitutional assertion).

Why: Making the sequence explicit and weighing competing historical interpretations prevents readers from collapsing events into a single dramatic moment and reinforces that the National Assembly emerged through a sequence of disputes, local mandates, and changing alliances rather than a simple walkout.

[medium] Newspapers and pamphlets just reported what was already happening — they were neutral, marginal sources that didn't shape the Revolution; the Revolution was caused by economic and social conditions, not by print culture.

- Diagnostic: Two rival pamphlets appear in a city within the same week: one argues the assembly should form immediately and gives meeting places and names of speakers; the other argues for patience and staying home. Within a month a mass meeting happens at the places the first pamphlet named and local leaders named in it speak. Which of the following is the best explanation?

A) The meeting would have happened anyway because economic pressure made it inevitable. B) The first pamphlet played an active role by persuading and coordinating people who then organised the meeting.

Reveals: Whether the student recognises print as an active organizer and persuasive agent rather than a neutral reporter; a wrong answer shows they downplay the causal role of print in shaping events.

- Diagnostic: Historians find that a radical newspaper had a sudden rise in subscribers just before a wave of demonstrations and that the paper named meeting dates and slogans. Which interpretation best fits the evidence?

A) The paper simply reported demonstrations others planned. B) The paper likely helped coordinate people by spreading slogans and practical information, so it contributed to the demonstrations.

Reveals: Whether the student uses timing and content evidence to infer active influence; a wrong answer shows they assume print only reflects events, not helps cause them.

- Remediation: Bring two short primary sources to class: a pamphlet/newspaper editorial that calls readers to a specific action (naming time/place/slogan) and a neutral-looking market report from the same month. Ask students in pairs to identify differences in audience, language, and intended effect, then map how the call-to-action could reach people in that city.

Why: Comparing contemporaneous primary texts makes the persuasive and organising features of print visible (naming places, giving instructions, using emotive rhetoric). This addresses the root error — seeing all print as neutral — by letting students read the evidence that some print deliberately sought to mobilise.

- Remediation: Present a short timeline with dates for pamphlet publications, newspaper circulation spikes, and subsequent local events (meetings, protests). Ask students to construct two competing interpretations (print caused the events vs print only reported them) and pick which the evidence better supports, citing specific timeline links.

Why: Making students weigh competing interpretations grounded in chronological evidence trains them to see causal plausibility — when persuasive print precedes and provides details for events, it is reasonable to infer influence. This directly counters the tendency to default to structural causes alone by showing how immediate communication interacts with those structures.

- Remediation: Introduce a short historian debate excerpt (two historians with different views on print's role). Have students annotate which historian uses which kinds of evidence (circulation figures, reader responses, government reactions) and then ask students to design what additional evidence would strengthen each claim.

Why: Exposing students to competing historical interpretations models the historian's method and emphasizes that claims rest on evidence (not just ideology). Asking for what would strengthen each side teaches students to look for concrete signs of causation (e.g., rapid spread of slogans, repression of presses) rather than assuming neutrality.

[low] Women had equal political rights and full inclusion throughout the French Revolution.

- Diagnostic: Did the 1791 and 1793 French constitutions grant women the right to vote and hold public office?

Reveals: If a student answers 'yes', they are treating early activist visibility as equivalent to formal legal rights and failing to track legal change across the Revolution.

- Diagnostic: Was the existence of organised women's political clubs legally protected throughout the Revolution, including after 1793?

Reveals: If a student answers 'no ban, they continued,' it shows they assume participation = continued inclusion and haven't noticed the October 1793 decree that outlawed women's clubs.

- Remediation: Document jigsaw: give small groups short, labeled primary-source extracts (Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen 1789, article excerpts from the 1791 Constitution, relevant articles from the 1793 Constitution, and the October 1793 decree banning women's clubs). Each group reads its extract, summarises what political rights (if any) it promises and for whom, then students re-form mixed groups to compare summaries and produce a one-sentence timeline statement about legal rights for women at each date.

Why: Exposure to the actual texts forces students to distinguish visible activism from legal status and to see the changing legal record across time. The jigsaw structure requires them to combine partial evidence rather than rely on a memorable episode, addressing the overgeneralisation from early activism.

- Remediation: Evidence timeline activity: provide mixed primary and secondary sources (pamphlets by women, contemporary newspaper reports of the March on Versailles, lists of women's societies, plus the 1791/1793 constitutional texts and the October 1793 police/jacobin decree). Students place each item on a classroom timeline and annotate whether it shows participation, legal recognition, or repression, then write a one-paragraph

explanation of how women's political status changed over time citing at least two pieces of evidence.

Why: Physically mapping events and documents highlights change over time and makes contradictions visible (high participation at certain moments vs later legal exclusion). Requiring citation trains students to ground claims in evidence and to resist sweeping statements based on a single dramatic example.

- Remediation: Perspective and causation discussion: present two short sources side-by-side — a letter or pamphlet by a female activist describing participation and demands, and the October 1793 decree or a Jacobin speech explaining the ban on women's clubs. Ask students in pairs to produce two brief arguments: (A) why revolutionaries supported women's inclusion early on; (B) why leaders later suppressed women's organisations. Then hold a class debate weighing competing interpretations, asking students to cite the documents and to consider context (war, internal dissent, fears of factionalism).

Why: This activity addresses both perspective and causation: students must account for why early inclusion did not guarantee continued rights and must evaluate competing historical explanations. It reinforces that the Revolution's policies changed in response to political context, not because women's activism always translated into formal equality.